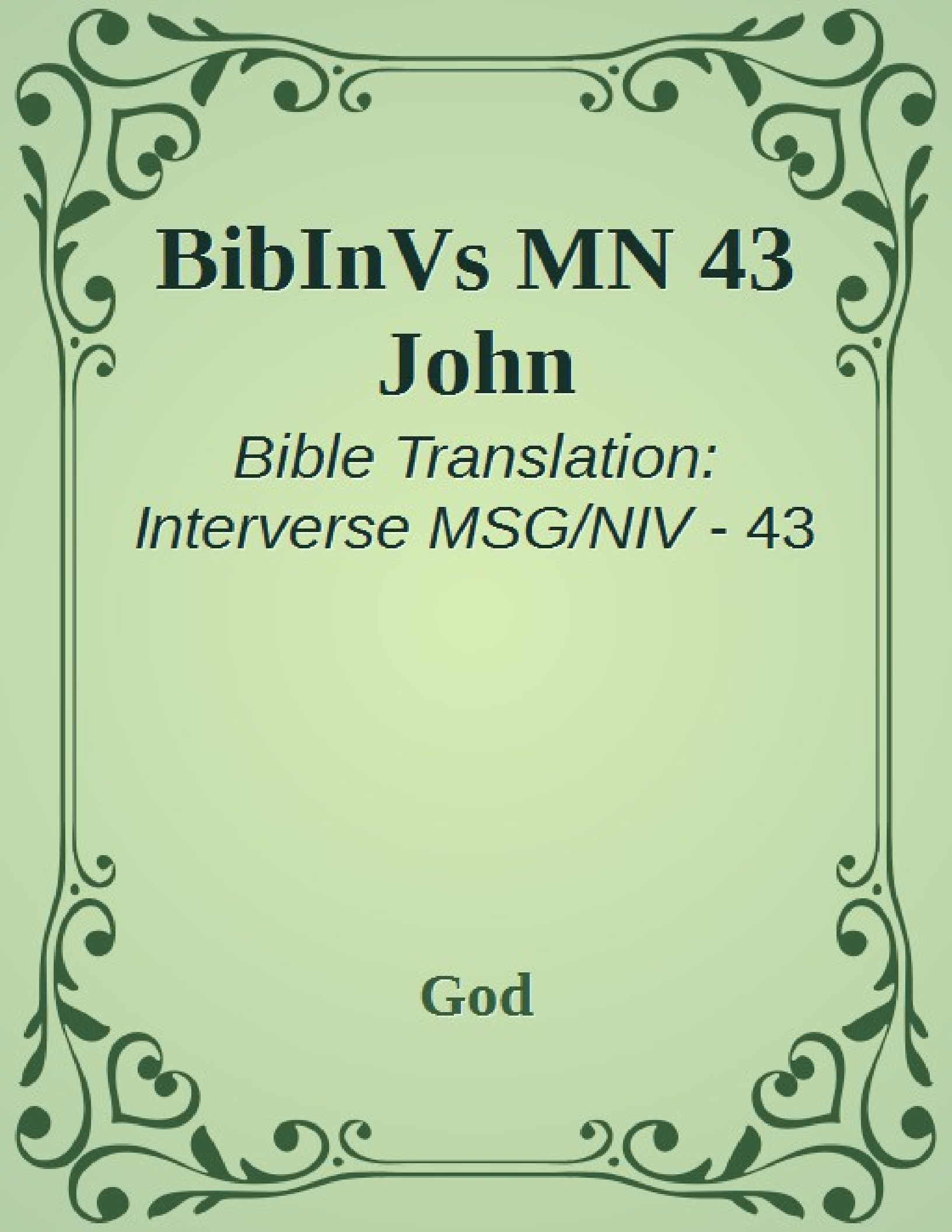


A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns, rendered in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 43

John

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 43*

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

John

John 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 The Word was first, the Word present to God, God present to the Word.
The Word was God,
- 1 In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.
- 2 in readiness for God from day one.
- 2 He was with God in the beginning.
- 3 Everything was created through him; nothing--not one thing!-- came into being without him.
- 3 Through him all things were made; without him nothing was made that has been made.
- 4 What came into existence was Life, and the Life was Light to live by.
- 4 In him was life, and that life was the light of men.
- 5 The Life-Light blazed out of the darkness; the darkness couldn't put it out.
- 5 The light shines in the darkness, but the darkness has not understood it.
- 6 There once was a man, his name John, sent by God
- 6 There came a man who was sent from God; his name was John.
- 7 to point out the way to the Life-Light. He came to show everyone where to look, who to believe in.
- 7 He came as a witness to testify concerning that light, so that through him all men might believe.
- 8 John was not himself the Light; he was there to show the way to the Light.
- 8 He himself was not the light; he came only as a witness to the light.
- 9 The Life-Light was the real thing: Every person entering Life he brings into Light.
- 9 The true light that gives light to every man was coming into the world.

- 10 He was in the world, the world was there through him, and yet the world didn't even notice.
- 10 He was in the world, and though the world was made through him, the world did not recognize him.
- 11 He came to his own people, but they didn't want him.
- 11 He came to that which was his own, but his own did not receive him.
- 12 But whoever did want him, who believed he was who he claimed and would do what he said, He made to be their true selves, their child-of-God selves.
- 12 Yet to all who received him, to those who believed in his name, he gave the right to become children of God--
- 13 These are the God-begotten, not blood-begotten, not flesh-begotten, not sex-begotten.
- 13 children born not of natural descent, nor of human decision or a husband's will, but born of God.
- 14 The Word became flesh and blood, and moved into the neighborhood. We saw the glory with our own eyes, the one-of-a-kind glory, like Father, like Son, Generous inside and out, true from start to finish.
- 14 The Word became flesh and made his dwelling among us. We have seen his glory, the glory of the One and Only, who came from the Father, full of grace and truth.
- 15 John pointed him out and called, "This is the One! The One I told you was coming after me but in fact was ahead of me. He has always been ahead of me, has always had the first word."
- 15 John testifies concerning him. He cries out, saying, "This was he of whom I said, 'He who comes after me has surpassed me because he was before me.' "
- 16 We all live off his generous bounty, gift after gift after gift.
- 16 From the fullness of his grace we have all received one blessing after another.
- 17 We got the basics from Moses, and then this exuberant giving and receiving, This endless knowing and understanding-- all this came through Jesus, the Messiah.
- 17 For the law was given through Moses; grace and truth came through Jesus Christ.

- 18 No one has ever seen God, not so much as a glimpse. This one-of-a-kind God-Expression, who exists at the very heart of the Father, has made him plain as day.
- 18 No one has ever seen God, but God the One and Only, who is at the Father's side, has made him known.
- 19 When Jews from Jerusalem sent a group of priests and officials to ask John who he was, he was completely honest.
- 19 Now this was John's testimony when the Jews of Jerusalem sent priests and Levites to ask him who he was.
- 20 He didn't evade the question. He told the plain truth: "I am not the Messiah."
- 20 He did not fail to confess, but confessed freely, "I am not the Christ. "
- 21 They pressed him, "Who, then? Elijah?" "I am not." "The Prophet?" "No."
- 21 They asked him, "Then who are you? Are you Elijah?" He said, "I am not." "Are you the Prophet?" He answered, "No."
- 22 Exasperated, they said, "Who, then? We need an answer for those who sent us. Tell us something--anything!--about yourself."
- 22 Finally they said, "Who are you? Give us an answer to take back to those who sent us. What do you say about yourself?"
- 23 "I'm thunder in the desert: 'Make the road straight for God!' I'm doing what the prophet Isaiah preached."
- 23 John replied in the words of Isaiah the prophet, "I am the voice of one calling in the desert, 'Make straight the way for the Lord.' "
- 24 Those sent to question him were from the Pharisee party.
- 24 Now some Pharisees who had been sent
- 25 Now they had a question of their own: "If you're neither the Messiah, nor Elijah, nor the Prophet, why do you baptize?"
- 25 questioned him, "Why then do you baptize if you are not the Christ, nor Elijah, nor the Prophet?"
- 26 John answered, "I only baptize using water. A person you don't recognize has taken his stand in your midst.
- 26 I baptize with water, John replied, "but among you stands one you do not know.
- 27 He comes after me, but he is not in second place to me. I'm not even worthy to hold his coat for him."

- 27 He is the one who comes after me, the thongs of whose sandals I am not worthy to untie."
- 28 These conversations took place in Bethany on the other side of the Jordan, where John was baptizing at the time.
- 28 This all happened at Bethany on the other side of the Jordan, where John was baptizing.
- 29 The very next day John saw Jesus coming toward him and yelled out,
- 29 The next day John saw Jesus coming toward him and said, "Look, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world!
- 30 "Here he is, God's Passover Lamb! He forgives the sins of the world! This is the man I've been talking about, 'the One who comes after me but is really ahead of me.'
- 30 This is the one I meant when I said, 'A man who comes after me has surpassed me because he was before me.'
- 31 I knew nothing about who he was--only this: that my task has been to get Israel ready to recognize him as the God-Revealer. That is why I came here baptizing with water, giving you a good bath and scrubbing sins from your life so you can get a fresh start with God."
- 31 I myself did not know him, but the reason I came baptizing with water was that he might be revealed to Israel."
- 32 John clinched his witness with this: "I watched the Spirit, like a dove flying down out of the sky, making himself at home in him.
- 32 Then John gave this testimony: "I saw the Spirit come down from heaven as a dove and remain on him.
- 33 I repeat, I know nothing about him except this: The One who authorized me to baptize with water told me, 'The One on whom you see the Spirit come down and stay, this One will baptize with the Holy Spirit.'
- 33 I would not have known him, except that the one who sent me to baptize with water told me, 'The man on whom you see the Spirit come down and remain is he who will baptize with the Holy Spirit.'
- 34 That's exactly what I saw happen, and I'm telling you, there's no question about it: This is the Son of God."
- 34 I have seen and I testify that this is the Son of God."
- 35 The next day John was back at his post with two disciples, who were watching.
- 35 The next day John was there again with two of his disciples.

36 He looked up, saw Jesus walking nearby, and said, "Here he is, God's
Passover Lamb."

36 When he saw Jesus passing by, he said, "Look, the Lamb of God!"

37 The two disciples heard him and went after Jesus.

37 When the two disciples heard him say this, they followed Jesus.

38 Jesus looked over his shoulder and said to them, "What are you after?"
They said, "Rabbi" (which means "Teacher"), "where are you staying?"

38 Turning around, Jesus saw them following and asked, "What do you
want?" They said, "Rabbi" (which means Teacher), "where are you
staying?"

39 He replied, "Come along and see for yourself." They came, saw where
he was living, and ended up staying with him for the day. It was late
afternoon when this happened.

39 Come, he replied, "and you will see." So they went and saw where he
was staying, and spent that day with him. It was about the tenth hour.

40 Andrew, Simon Peter's brother, was one of the two who heard John's
witness and followed Jesus.

40 Andrew, Simon Peter's brother, was one of the two who heard what
John had said and who had followed Jesus.

41 The first thing he did after finding where Jesus lived was find his own
brother, Simon, telling him, "We've found the Messiah" (that is,
"Christ").

41 The first thing Andrew did was to find his brother Simon and tell him,
"We have found the Messiah" (that is, the Christ).

42 He immediately led him to Jesus. Jesus took one look up and said,
"You're John's son, Simon? From now on your name is Cephas" (or
Peter, which means "Rock").

42 And he brought him to Jesus. Jesus looked at him and said, "You are
Simon son of John. You will be called Cephas" (which, when translated,
is Peter).

43 The next day Jesus decided to go to Galilee. When he got there, he ran
across Philip and said, "Come, follow me."

43 The next day Jesus decided to leave for Galilee. Finding Philip, he said
to him, "Follow me."

44 (Philip's hometown was Bethsaida, the same as Andrew and Peter.)

44 Philip, like Andrew and Peter, was from the town of Bethsaida.

- 45 Philip went and found Nathanael and told him, "We've found the One Moses wrote of in the Law, the One preached by the prophets. It's Jesus, Joseph's son, the one from Nazareth!"
- 45 Philip found Nathanael and told him, "We have found the one Moses wrote about in the Law, and about whom the prophets also wrote--Jesus of Nazareth, the son of Joseph."
- 46 Nathanael said, "Nazareth? You've got to be kidding." But Philip said, "Come, see for yourself."
- 46 Nazareth! Can anything good come from there? Nathanael asked. "Come and see," said Philip.
- 47 When Jesus saw him coming he said, "There's a real Israelite, not a false bone in his body."
- 47 When Jesus saw Nathanael approaching, he said of him, "Here is a true Israelite, in whom there is nothing false."
- 48 Nathanael said, "Where did you get that idea? You don't know me." Jesus answered, "One day, long before Philip called you here, I saw you under the fig tree."
- 48 How do you know me? Nathanael asked. Jesus answered, "I saw you while you were still under the fig tree before Philip called you."
- 49 Nathanael exclaimed, "Rabbi! You are the Son of God, the King of Israel!"
- 49 Then Nathanael declared, "Rabbi, you are the Son of God; you are the King of Israel."
- 50 Jesus said, "You've become a believer simply because I say I saw you one day sitting under the fig tree? You haven't seen anything yet!"
- 50 Jesus said, "You believe because I told you I saw you under the fig tree. You shall see greater things than that."
- 51 Before this is over you're going to see heaven open and God's angels descending to the Son of Man and ascending again."
- 51 He then added, "I tell you the truth, you shall see heaven open, and the angels of God ascending and descending on the Son of Man."

John 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 Three days later there was a wedding in the village of Cana in Galilee. Jesus' mother was there.
- 1 On the third day a wedding took place at Cana in Galilee. Jesus' mother was there,
- 2 Jesus and his disciples were guests also.
- 2 and Jesus and his disciples had also been invited to the wedding.
- 3 When they started running low on wine at the wedding banquet, Jesus' mother told him, "They're just about out of wine."
- 3 When the wine was gone, Jesus' mother said to him, "They have no more wine."
- 4 Jesus said, "Is that any of our business, Mother--yours or mine? This isn't my time. Don't push me."
- 4 Dear woman, why do you involve me? Jesus replied. "My time has not yet come."
- 5 She went ahead anyway, telling the servants, "Whatever he tells you, do it."
- 5 His mother said to the servants, "Do whatever he tells you."
- 6 Six stoneware water pots were there, used by the Jews for ritual washings. Each held twenty to thirty gallons.
- 6 Nearby stood six stone water jars, the kind used by the Jews for ceremonial washing, each holding from twenty to thirty gallons.
- 7 Jesus ordered the servants, "Fill the pots with water." And they filled them to the brim.
- 7 Jesus said to the servants, "Fill the jars with water"; so they filled them to the brim.
- 8 "Now fill your pitchers and take them to the host," Jesus said, and they did.
- 8 Then he told them, "Now draw some out and take it to the master of the banquet." They did so,
- 9 When the host tasted the water that had become wine (he didn't know what had just happened but the servants, of course, knew), he called out to the bridegroom,
- 9 and the master of the banquet tasted the water that had been turned into wine. He did not realize where it had come from, though the servants who had drawn the water knew. Then he called the bridegroom aside

- 10 "Everybody I know begins with their finest wines and after the guests have had their fill brings in the cheap stuff. But you've saved the best till now!"
- 10 and said, "Everyone brings out the choice wine first and then the cheaper wine after the guests have had too much to drink; but you have saved the best till now."
- 11 This act in Cana of Galilee was the first sign Jesus gave, the first glimpse of his glory. And his disciples believed in him.
- 11 This, the first of his miraculous signs, Jesus performed at Cana in Galilee. He thus revealed his glory, and his disciples put their faith in him.
- 12 After this he went down to Capernaum along with his mother, brothers, and disciples, and stayed several days.
- 12 After this he went down to Capernaum with his mother and brothers and his disciples. There they stayed for a few days.
- 13 When the Passover Feast, celebrated each spring by the Jews, was about to take place, Jesus traveled up to Jerusalem.
- 13 When it was almost time for the Jewish Passover, Jesus went up to Jerusalem.
- 14 He found the Temple teeming with people selling cattle and sheep and doves. The loan sharks were also there in full strength.
- 14 In the temple courts he found men selling cattle, sheep and doves, and others sitting at tables exchanging money.
- 15 Jesus put together a whip out of strips of leather and chased them out of the Temple, stampeding the sheep and cattle, upending the tables of the loan sharks, spilling coins left and right.
- 15 So he made a whip out of cords, and drove all from the temple area, both sheep and cattle; he scattered the coins of the money changers and overturned their tables.
- 16 He told the dove merchants, "Get your things out of here! Stop turning my Father's house into a shopping mall!"
- 16 To those who sold doves he said, "Get these out of here! How dare you turn my Father's house into a market!"
- 17 That's when his disciples remembered the Scripture, "Zeal for your house consumes me."

- 17 His disciples remembered that it is written: "Zeal for your house will consume me."
- 18 But the Jews were upset. They asked, "What credentials can you present to justify this?"
- 18 Then the Jews demanded of him, "What miraculous sign can you show us to prove your authority to do all this?"
- 19 Jesus answered, "Tear down this Temple and in three days I'll put it back together."
- 19 Jesus answered them, "Destroy this temple, and I will raise it again in three days."
- 20 They were indignant: "It took forty-six years to build this Temple, and you're going to rebuild it in three days?"
- 20 The Jews replied, "It has taken forty-six years to build this temple, and you are going to raise it in three days?"
- 21 But Jesus was talking about his body as the Temple.
- 21 But the temple he had spoken of was his body.
- 22 Later, after he was raised from the dead, his disciples remembered he had said this. They then put two and two together and believed both what was written in Scripture and what Jesus had said.
- 22 After he was raised from the dead, his disciples recalled what he had said. Then they believed the Scripture and the words that Jesus had spoken.
- 23 During the time he was in Jerusalem, those days of the Passover Feast, many people noticed the signs he was displaying and, seeing they pointed straight to God, entrusted their lives to him.
- 23 Now while he was in Jerusalem at the Passover Feast, many people saw the miraculous signs he was doing and believed in his name.
- 24 But Jesus didn't entrust his life to them. He knew them inside and out, knew how untrustworthy they were.
- 24 But Jesus would not entrust himself to them, for he knew all men.
- 25 He didn't need any help in seeing right through them.
- 25 He did not need man's testimony about man, for he knew what was in a man.

John 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 There was a man of the Pharisee sect, Nicodemus, a prominent leader among the Jews.
- 1 Now there was a man of the Pharisees named Nicodemus, a member of the Jewish ruling council.
- 2 Late one night he visited Jesus and said, "Rabbi, we all know you're a teacher straight from God. No one could do all the God-pointing, God-revealing acts you do if God weren't in on it."
- 2 He came to Jesus at night and said, "Rabbi, we know you are a teacher who has come from God. For no one could perform the miraculous signs you are doing if God were not with him."
- 3 Jesus said, "You're absolutely right. Take it from me: Unless a person is born from above, it's not possible to see what I'm pointing to--to God's kingdom."
- 3 In reply Jesus declared, "I tell you the truth, no one can see the kingdom of God unless he is born again. "
- 4 "How can anyone," said Nicodemus, "be born who has already been born and grown up? You can't re-enter your mother's womb and be born again. What are you saying with this 'born-from-above' talk?"
- 4 How can a man be born when he is old? Nicodemus asked. "Surely he cannot enter a second time into his mother's womb to be born!"
- 5 Jesus said, "You're not listening. Let me say it again. Unless a person submits to this original creation--the 'wind hovering over the water' creation, the invisible moving the visible, a baptism into a new life--it's not possible to enter God's kingdom.
- 5 Jesus answered, "I tell you the truth, no one can enter the kingdom of God unless he is born of water and the Spirit.
- 6 When you look at a baby, it's just that: a body you can look at and touch. But the person who takes shape within is formed by something you can't see and touch--the Spirit--and becomes a living spirit.
- 6 Flesh gives birth to flesh, but the Spirit gives birth to spirit.
- 7 "So don't be so surprised when I tell you that you have to be 'born from above'--out of this world, so to speak.
- 7 You should not be surprised at my saying, 'You must be born again.'

- 8 You know well enough how the wind blows this way and that. You hear it rustling through the trees, but you have no idea where it comes from or where it's headed next. That's the way it is with everyone 'born from above' by the wind of God, the Spirit of God."
- 8 The wind blows wherever it pleases. You hear its sound, but you cannot tell where it comes from or where it is going. So it is with everyone born of the Spirit."
- 9 Nicodemus asked, "What do you mean by this? How does this happen?"
- 9 How can this be? Nicodemus asked.
- 10 Jesus said, "You're a respected teacher of Israel and you don't know these basics?"
- 10 You are Israel's teacher, said Jesus, "and do you not understand these things?"
- 11 Listen carefully. I'm speaking sober truth to you. I speak only of what I know by experience; I give witness only to what I have seen with my own eyes. There is nothing secondhand here, no hearsay. Yet instead of facing the evidence and accepting it, you procrastinate with questions.
- 11 I tell you the truth, we speak of what we know, and we testify to what we have seen, but still you people do not accept our testimony.
- 12 If I tell you things that are plain as the hand before your face and you don't believe me, what use is there in telling you of things you can't see, the things of God?
- 12 I have spoken to you of earthly things and you do not believe; how then will you believe if I speak of heavenly things?
- 13 "No one has ever gone up into the presence of God except the One who came down from that Presence, the Son of Man.
- 13 No one has ever gone into heaven except the one who came from heaven--the Son of Man.
- 14 In the same way that Moses lifted the serpent in the desert so people could have something to see and then believe, it is necessary for the Son of Man to be lifted up--
- 14 Just as Moses lifted up the snake in the desert, so the Son of Man must be lifted up,
- 15 and everyone who looks up to him, trusting and expectant, will gain a real life, eternal life.
- 15 that everyone who believes in him may have eternal life.

- 16 "This is how much God loved the world: He gave his Son, his one and only Son. And this is why: so that no one need be destroyed; by believing in him, anyone can have a whole and lasting life.
- 16 For God so loved the world that he gave his one and only Son, that whoever believes in him shall not perish but have eternal life.
- 17 God didn't go to all the trouble of sending his Son merely to point an accusing finger, telling the world how bad it was. He came to help, to put the world right again.
- 17 For God did not send his Son into the world to condemn the world, but to save the world through him.
- 18 Anyone who trusts in him is acquitted; anyone who refuses to trust him has long since been under the death sentence without knowing it. And why? Because of that person's failure to believe in the one-of-a-kind Son of God when introduced to him.
- 18 Whoever believes in him is not condemned, but whoever does not believe stands condemned already because he has not believed in the name of God's one and only Son.
- 19 "This is the crisis we're in: God-light streamed into the world, but men and women everywhere ran for the darkness. They went for the darkness because they were not really interested in pleasing God.
- 19 This is the verdict: Light has come into the world, but men loved darkness instead of light because their deeds were evil.
- 20 Everyone who makes a practice of doing evil, addicted to denial and illusion, hates God-light and won't come near it, fearing a painful exposure.
- 20 Everyone who does evil hates the light, and will not come into the light for fear that his deeds will be exposed.
- 21 But anyone working and living in truth and reality welcomes God-light so the work can be seen for the God-work it is."
- 21 But whoever lives by the truth comes into the light, so that it may be seen plainly that what he has done has been done through God."
- 22 After this conversation, Jesus went on with his disciples into the Judean countryside and relaxed with them there. He was also baptizing.
- 22 After this, Jesus and his disciples went out into the Judean countryside, where he spent some time with them, and baptized.

- 23 At the same time, John was baptizing over at Aenon near Salim, where water was abundant.
- 23 Now John also was baptizing at Aenon near Salim, because there was plenty of water, and people were constantly coming to be baptized.
- 24 This was before John was thrown into jail.
- 24 (This was before John was put in prison.)
- 25 John's disciples got into an argument with the establishment Jews over the nature of baptism.
- 25 An argument developed between some of John's disciples and a certain Jew over the matter of ceremonial washing.
- 26 They came to John and said, "Rabbi, you know the one who was with you on the other side of the Jordan? The one you authorized with your witness? Well, he's now competing with us. He's baptizing, too, and everyone's going to him instead of us."
- 26 They came to John and said to him, "Rabbi, that man who was with you on the other side of the Jordan--the one you testified about--well, he is baptizing, and everyone is going to him."
- 27 John answered, "It's not possible for a person to succeed--I'm talking about eternal success--without heaven's help.
- 27 To this John replied, "A man can receive only what is given him from heaven.
- 28 You yourselves were there when I made it public that I was not the Messiah but simply the one sent ahead of him to get things ready.
- 28 You yourselves can testify that I said, 'I am not the Christ but am sent ahead of him.'
- 29 The one who gets the bride is, by definition, the bridegroom. And the bridegroom's friend, his 'best man'--that's me--in place at his side where he can hear every word, is genuinely happy. How could he be jealous when he knows that the wedding is finished and the marriage is off to a good start? "That's why my cup is running over.
- 29 The bride belongs to the bridegroom. The friend who attends the bridegroom waits and listens for him, and is full of joy when he hears the bridegroom's voice. That joy is mine, and it is now complete.
- 30 This is the assigned moment for him to move into the center, while I slip off to the sidelines.
- 30 He must become greater; I must become less.

- 31 "The One who comes from above is head and shoulders over other messengers from God. The earthborn is earthbound and speaks earth language; the heavenborn is in a league of his own.
- 31 The one who comes from above is above all; the one who is from the earth belongs to the earth, and speaks as one from the earth. The one who comes from heaven is above all.
- 32 He sets out the evidence of what he saw and heard in heaven. No one wants to deal with these facts.
- 32 He testifies to what he has seen and heard, but no one accepts his testimony.
- 33 But anyone who examines this evidence will come to stake his life on this: that God himself is the truth.
- 33 The man who has accepted it has certified that God is truthful.
- 34 "The One that God sent speaks God's words. And don't think he rations out the Spirit in bits and pieces.
- 34 For the one whom God has sent speaks the words of God, for God gives the Spirit without limit.
- 35 The Father loves the Son extravagantly. He turned everything over to him so he could give it away--a lavish distribution of gifts.
- 35 The Father loves the Son and has placed everything in his hands.
- 36 That is why whoever accepts and trusts the Son gets in on everything, life complete and forever! And that is also why the person who avoids and distrusts the Son is in the dark and doesn't see life. All he experiences of God is darkness, and an angry darkness at that."
- 36 Whoever believes in the Son has eternal life, but whoever rejects the Son will not see life, for God's wrath remains on him."

John 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 Jesus realized that the Pharisees were keeping count of the baptisms that he and John performed
- 1 The Pharisees heard that Jesus was gaining and baptizing more disciples than John,

- 2 (although his disciples, not Jesus, did the actual baptizing). They had posted the score that Jesus was ahead, turning him and John into rivals in the eyes of the people.
- 2 although in fact it was not Jesus who baptized, but his disciples.
- 3 So Jesus left the Judean countryside and went back to Galilee.
- 3 When the Lord learned of this, he left Judea and went back once more to Galilee.
- 4 To get there, he had to pass through Samaria.
- 4 Now he had to go through Samaria.
- 5 He came into Sychar, a Samaritan village that bordered the field Jacob had given his son Joseph.
- 5 So he came to a town in Samaria called Sychar, near the plot of ground Jacob had given to his son Joseph.
- 6 Jacob's well was still there. Jesus, worn out by the trip, sat down at the well. It was noon.
- 6 Jacob's well was there, and Jesus, tired as he was from the journey, sat down by the well. It was about the sixth hour.
- 7 A woman, a Samaritan, came to draw water. Jesus said, "Would you give me a drink of water?"
- 7 When a Samaritan woman came to draw water, Jesus said to her, "Will you give me a drink?"
- 8 (His disciples had gone to the village to buy food for lunch.)
- 8 (His disciples had gone into the town to buy food.)
- 9 The Samaritan woman, taken aback, asked, "How come you, a Jew, are asking me, a Samaritan woman, for a drink?" (Jews in those days wouldn't be caught dead talking to Samaritans.)
- 9 The Samaritan woman said to him, "You are a Jew and I am a Samaritan woman. How can you ask me for a drink?" (For Jews do not associate with Samaritans.)
- 10 Jesus answered, "If you knew the generosity of God and who I am, you would be asking me for a drink, and I would give you fresh, living water."
- 10 Jesus answered her, "If you knew the gift of God and who it is that asks you for a drink, you would have asked him and he would have given you living water."

- 11 The woman said, "Sir, you don't even have a bucket to draw with, and this well is deep. So how are you going to get this 'living water'?"
- 11 Sir, the woman said, "you have nothing to draw with and the well is deep. Where can you get this living water?"
- 12 Are you a better man than our ancestor Jacob, who dug this well and drank from it, he and his sons and livestock, and passed it down to us?"
- 12 Are you greater than our father Jacob, who gave us the well and drank from it himself, as did also his sons and his flocks and herds?"
- 13 Jesus said, "Everyone who drinks this water will get thirsty again and again.
- 13 Jesus answered, "Everyone who drinks this water will be thirsty again,
- 14 Anyone who drinks the water I give will never thirst--not ever. The water I give will be an artesian spring within, gushing fountains of endless life."
- 14 but whoever drinks the water I give him will never thirst. Indeed, the water I give him will become in him a spring of water welling up to eternal life."
- 15 The woman said, "Sir, give me this water so I won't ever get thirsty, won't ever have to come back to this well again!"
- 15 The woman said to him, "Sir, give me this water so that I won't get thirsty and have to keep coming here to draw water."
- 16 He said, "Go call your husband and then come back."
- 16 He told her, "Go, call your husband and come back."
- 17 "I have no husband," she said. "That's nicely put: 'I have no husband.'"
- 17 I have no husband, she replied. Jesus said to her, "You are right when you say you have no husband.
- 18 You've had five husbands, and the man you're living with now isn't even your husband. You spoke the truth there, sure enough."
- 18 The fact is, you have had five husbands, and the man you now have is not your husband. What you have just said is quite true."
- 19 "Oh, so you're a prophet!"
- 19 Sir, the woman said, "I can see that you are a prophet.
- 20 Well, tell me this: Our ancestors worshiped God at this mountain, but you Jews insist that Jerusalem is the only place for worship, right?"
- 20 Our fathers worshiped on this mountain, but you Jews claim that the place where we must worship is in Jerusalem."

- 21 "Believe me, woman, the time is coming when you Samaritans will worship the Father neither here at this mountain nor there in Jerusalem.
- 21 Jesus declared, "Believe me, woman, a time is coming when you will worship the Father neither on this mountain nor in Jerusalem.
- 22 You worship guessing in the dark; we Jews worship in the clear light of day. God's way of salvation is made available through the Jews.
- 22 You Samaritans worship what you do not know; we worship what we do know, for salvation is from the Jews.
- 23 But the time is coming--it has, in fact, come--when what you're called will not matter and where you go to worship will not matter. "It's who you are and the way you live that count before God. Your worship must engage your spirit in the pursuit of truth. That's the kind of people the Father is out looking for: those who are simply and honestly themselves before him in their worship.
- 23 Yet a time is coming and has now come when the true worshipers will worship the Father in spirit and truth, for they are the kind of worshipers the Father seeks.
- 24 God is sheer being itself--Spirit. Those who worship him must do it out of their very being, their spirits, their true selves, in adoration."
- 24 God is spirit, and his worshipers must worship in spirit and in truth."
- 25 The woman said, "I don't know about that. I do know that the Messiah is coming. When he arrives, we'll get the whole story."
- 25 The woman said, "I know that Messiah" (called Christ) "is coming. When he comes, he will explain everything to us."
- 26 "I am he," said Jesus. "You don't have to wait any longer or look any further."
- 26 Then Jesus declared, "I who speak to you am he."
- 27 Just then his disciples came back. They were shocked. They couldn't believe he was talking with that kind of a woman. No one said what they were all thinking, but their faces showed it.
- 27 Just then his disciples returned and were surprised to find him talking with a woman. But no one asked, "What do you want?" or "Why are you talking with her?"
- 28 The woman took the hint and left. In her confusion she left her water pot. Back in the village she told the people,

28 Then, leaving her water jar, the woman went back to the town and said to the people,

29 "Come see a man who knew all about the things I did, who knows me inside and out. Do you think this could be the Messiah?"

29 Come, see a man who told me everything I ever did. Could this be the Christ?

30 And they went out to see for themselves.

30 They came out of the town and made their way toward him.

31 In the meantime, the disciples pressed him, "Rabbi, eat. Aren't you going to eat?"

31 Meanwhile his disciples urged him, "Rabbi, eat something."

32 He told them, "I have food to eat you know nothing about."

32 But he said to them, "I have food to eat that you know nothing about."

33 The disciples were puzzled. "Who could have brought him food?"

33 Then his disciples said to each other, "Could someone have brought him food?"

34 Jesus said, "The food that keeps me going is that I do the will of the One who sent me, finishing the work he started.

34 My food, said Jesus, "is to do the will of him who sent me and to finish his work.

35 As you look around right now, wouldn't you say that in about four months it will be time to harvest? Well, I'm telling you to open your eyes and take a good look at what's right in front of you. These Samaritan fields are ripe. It's harvest time!

35 Do you not say, 'Four months more and then the harvest'? I tell you, open your eyes and look at the fields! They are ripe for harvest.

36 "The Harvester isn't waiting. He's taking his pay, gathering in this grain that's ripe for eternal life. Now the Sower is arm in arm with the Harvester, triumphant.

36 Even now the reaper draws his wages, even now he harvests the crop for eternal life, so that the sower and the reaper may be glad together.

37 That's the truth of the saying, 'This one sows, that one harvests.'

37 Thus the saying 'One sows and another reaps' is true.

38 I sent you to harvest a field you never worked. Without lifting a finger, you have walked in on a field worked long and hard by others."

- 38 I sent you to reap what you have not worked for. Others have done the hard work, and you have reaped the benefits of their labor."
- 39 Many of the Samaritans from that village committed themselves to him because of the woman's witness: "He knew all about the things I did. He knows me inside and out!"
- 39 Many of the Samaritans from that town believed in him because of the woman's testimony, "He told me everything I ever did."
- 40 They asked him to stay on, so Jesus stayed two days.
- 40 So when the Samaritans came to him, they urged him to stay with them, and he stayed two days.
- 41 A lot more people entrusted their lives to him when they heard what he had to say.
- 41 And because of his words many more became believers.
- 42 They said to the woman, "We're no longer taking this on your say-so. We've heard it for ourselves and know it for sure. He's the Savior of the world!"
- 42 They said to the woman, "We no longer believe just because of what you said; now we have heard for ourselves, and we know that this man really is the Savior of the world."
- 43 After the two days he left for Galilee.
- 43 After the two days he left for Galilee.
- 44 Now, Jesus knew well from experience that a prophet is not respected in the place where he grew up.
- 44 (Now Jesus himself had pointed out that a prophet has no honor in his own country.)
- 45 So when he arrived in Galilee, the Galileans welcomed him, but only because they were impressed with what he had done in Jerusalem during the Passover Feast, not that they really had a clue about who he was or what he was up to.
- 45 When he arrived in Galilee, the Galileans welcomed him. They had seen all that he had done in Jerusalem at the Passover Feast, for they also had been there.
- 46 Now he was back in Cana of Galilee, the place where he made the water into wine. Meanwhile in Capernaum, there was a certain official from the king's court whose son was sick.

- 46 Once more he visited Cana in Galilee, where he had turned the water into wine. And there was a certain royal official whose son lay sick at Capernaum.
- 47 When he heard that Jesus had come from Judea to Galilee, he went and asked that he come down and heal his son, who was on the brink of death.
- 47 When this man heard that Jesus had arrived in Galilee from Judea, he went to him and begged him to come and heal his son, who was close to death.
- 48 Jesus put him off: "Unless you people are dazzled by a miracle, you refuse to believe."
- 48 Unless you people see miraculous signs and wonders, Jesus told him, "you will never believe."
- 49 But the court official wouldn't be put off. "Come down! It's life or death for my son."
- 49 The royal official said, "Sir, come down before my child dies."
- 50 Jesus simply replied, "Go home. Your son lives." The man believed the bare word Jesus spoke and headed home.
- 50 Jesus replied, "You may go. Your son will live." The man took Jesus at his word and departed.
- 51 On his way back, his servants intercepted him and announced, "Your son lives!"
- 51 While he was still on the way, his servants met him with the news that his boy was living.
- 52 He asked them what time he began to get better. They said, "The fever broke yesterday afternoon at one o'clock."
- 52 When he inquired as to the time when his son got better, they said to him, "The fever left him yesterday at the seventh hour."
- 53 The father knew that that was the very moment Jesus had said, "Your son lives." That clinched it. Not only he but his entire household believed.
- 53 Then the father realized that this was the exact time at which Jesus had said to him, "Your son will live." So he and all his household believed.
- 54 This was now the second sign Jesus gave after having come from Judea into Galilee.

54 This was the second miraculous sign that Jesus performed, having come from Judea to Galilee.

John 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 Soon another Feast came around and Jesus was back in Jerusalem.
- 1 Some time later, Jesus went up to Jerusalem for a feast of the Jews.
- 2 Near the Sheep Gate in Jerusalem there was a pool, in Hebrew called Bethesda, with five alcoves.
- 2 Now there is in Jerusalem near the Sheep Gate a pool, which in Aramaic is called Bethesda and which is surrounded by five covered colonnades.
- 3 Hundreds of sick people--blind, crippled, paralyzed--were in these alcoves.
- 3 Here a great number of disabled people used to lie--the blind, the lame, the paralyzed.
- 4 (OMITTED TEXT)
- 5 One man had been an invalid there for thirty-eight years.
- 5 One who was there had been an invalid for thirty-eight years.
- 6 When Jesus saw him stretched out by the pool and knew how long he had been there, he said, "Do you want to get well?"
- 6 When Jesus saw him lying there and learned that he had been in this condition for a long time, he asked him, "Do you want to get well?"
- 7 The sick man said, "Sir, when the water is stirred, I don't have anybody to put me in the pool. By the time I get there, somebody else is already in."
- 7 Sir, the invalid replied, "I have no one to help me into the pool when the water is stirred. While I am trying to get in, someone else goes down ahead of me."
- 8 Jesus said, "Get up, take your bedroll, start walking."
- 8 Then Jesus said to him, "Get up! Pick up your mat and walk."
- 9 The man was healed on the spot. He picked up his bedroll and walked off. That day happened to be the Sabbath.
- 9 At once the man was cured; he picked up his mat and walked. The day on which this took place was a Sabbath,

- 10 The Jews stopped the healed man and said, "It's the Sabbath. You can't carry your bedroll around. It's against the rules."
- 10 and so the Jews said to the man who had been healed, "It is the Sabbath; the law forbids you to carry your mat."
- 11 But he told them, "The man who made me well told me to. He said, 'Take your bedroll and start walking.'"
- 11 But he replied, "The man who made me well said to me, 'Pick up your mat and walk.' "
- 12 They asked, "Who gave you the order to take it up and start walking?"
- 12 So they asked him, "Who is this fellow who told you to pick it up and walk?"
- 13 But the healed man didn't know, for Jesus had slipped away into the crowd.
- 13 The man who was healed had no idea who it was, for Jesus had slipped away into the crowd that was there.
- 14 A little later Jesus found him in the Temple and said, "You look wonderful! You're well! Don't return to a sinning life or something worse might happen."
- 14 Later Jesus found him at the temple and said to him, "See, you are well again. Stop sinning or something worse may happen to you."
- 15 The man went back and told the Jews that it was Jesus who had made him well.
- 15 The man went away and told the Jews that it was Jesus who had made him well.
- 16 That is why the Jews were out to get Jesus--because he did this kind of thing on the Sabbath.
- 16 So, because Jesus was doing these things on the Sabbath, the Jews persecuted him.
- 17 But Jesus defended himself. "My Father is working straight through, even on the Sabbath. So am I."
- 17 Jesus said to them, "My Father is always at his work to this very day, and I, too, am working."
- 18 That really set them off. The Jews were now not only out to expose him; they were out to kill him. Not only was he breaking the Sabbath, but he was calling God his own Father, putting himself on a level with God.

- 18 For this reason the Jews tried all the harder to kill him; not only was he breaking the Sabbath, but he was even calling God his own Father, making himself equal with God.
- 19 So Jesus explained himself at length. "I'm telling you this straight. The Son can't independently do a thing, only what he sees the Father doing. What the Father does, the Son does.
- 19 Jesus gave them this answer: "I tell you the truth, the Son can do nothing by himself; he can do only what he sees his Father doing, because whatever the Father does the Son also does.
- 20 The Father loves the Son and includes him in everything he is doing. "But you haven't seen the half of it yet,
- 20 For the Father loves the Son and shows him all he does. Yes, to your amazement he will show him even greater things than these.
- 21 for in the same way that the Father raises the dead and creates life, so does the Son. The Son gives life to anyone he chooses.
- 21 For just as the Father raises the dead and gives them life, even so the Son gives life to whom he is pleased to give it.
- 22 Neither he nor the Father shuts anyone out. The Father handed all authority to judge over to the Son
- 22 Moreover, the Father judges no one, but has entrusted all judgment to the Son,
- 23 so that the Son will be honored equally with the Father. Anyone who dishonors the Son, dishonors the Father, for it was the Father's decision to put the Son in the place of honor.
- 23 that all may honor the Son just as they honor the Father. He who does not honor the Son does not honor the Father, who sent him.
- 24 "It's urgent that you listen carefully to this: Anyone here who believes what I am saying right now and aligns himself with the Father, who has in fact put me in charge, has at this very moment the real, lasting life and is no longer condemned to be an outsider. This person has taken a giant step from the world of the dead to the world of the living.
- 24 I tell you the truth, whoever hears my word and believes him who sent me has eternal life and will not be condemned; he has crossed over from death to life.
- 25 "It's urgent that you get this right: The time has arrived--I mean right now!--when dead men and women will hear the voice of the Son of God

and, hearing, will come alive.

25 I tell you the truth, a time is coming and has now come when the dead will hear the voice of the Son of God and those who hear will live.

26 Just as the Father has life in himself, he has conferred on the Son life in himself.

26 For as the Father has life in himself, so he has granted the Son to have life in himself.

27 And he has given him the authority, simply because he is the Son of Man, to decide and carry out matters of Judgment.

27 And he has given him authority to judge because he is the Son of Man.

28 "Don't act so surprised at all this. The time is coming when everyone dead and buried will hear his voice.

28 Do not be amazed at this, for a time is coming when all who are in their graves will hear his voice

29 Those who have lived the right way will walk out into a resurrection Life; those who have lived the wrong way, into a resurrection Judgment.

29 and come out--those who have done good will rise to live, and those who have done evil will rise to be condemned.

30 "I can't do a solitary thing on my own: I listen, then I decide. You can trust my decision because I'm not out to get my own way but only to carry out orders.

30 By myself I can do nothing; I judge only as I hear, and my judgment is just, for I seek not to please myself but him who sent me.

31 If I were simply speaking on my own account, it would be an empty, self-serving witness.

31 If I testify about myself, my testimony is not valid.

32 But an independent witness confirms me, the most reliable Witness of all.

32 There is another who testifies in my favor, and I know that his testimony about me is valid.

33 Furthermore, you all saw and heard John, and he gave expert and reliable testimony about me, didn't he?

33 You have sent to John and he has testified to the truth.

34 "But my purpose is not to get your vote, and not to appeal to mere human testimony. I'm speaking to you this way so that you will be saved.

34 Not that I accept human testimony; but I mention it that you may be saved.

35 John was a torch, blazing and bright, and you were glad enough to dance for an hour or so in his bright light.

35 John was a lamp that burned and gave light, and you chose for a time to enjoy his light.

36 But the witness that really confirms me far exceeds John's witness. It's the work the Father gave me to complete. These very tasks, as I go about completing them, confirm that the Father, in fact, sent me.

36 I have testimony weightier than that of John. For the very work that the Father has given me to finish, and which I am doing, testifies that the Father has sent me.

37 The Father who sent me, confirmed me. And you missed it. You never heard his voice, you never saw his appearance.

37 And the Father who sent me has himself testified concerning me. You have never heard his voice nor seen his form,

38 There is nothing left in your memory of his Message because you do not take his Messenger seriously.

38 nor does his word dwell in you, for you do not believe the one he sent.

39 "You have your heads in your Bibles constantly because you think you'll find eternal life there. But you miss the forest for the trees. These Scriptures are all about me!

39 You diligently study the Scriptures because you think that by them you possess eternal life. These are the Scriptures that testify about me,

40 And here I am, standing right before you, and you aren't willing to receive from me the life you say you want.

40 yet you refuse to come to me to have life.

41 "I'm not interested in crowd approval.

41 I do not accept praise from men,

42 And do you know why? Because I know you and your crowds. I know that love, especially God's love, is not on your working agenda.

42 but I know you. I know that you do not have the love of God in your hearts.

43 I came with the authority of my Father, and you either dismiss me or avoid me. If another came, acting self-important, you would welcome him with open arms.

- 43 I have come in my Father's name, and you do not accept me; but if someone else comes in his own name, you will accept him.
- 44 How do you expect to get anywhere with God when you spend all your time jockeying for position with each other, ranking your rivals and ignoring God?
- 44 How can you believe if you accept praise from one another, yet make no effort to obtain the praise that comes from the only God?
- 45 "But don't think I'm going to accuse you before my Father. Moses, in whom you put so much stock, is your accuser.
- 45 But do not think I will accuse you before the Father. Your accuser is Moses, on whom your hopes are set.
- 46 If you believed, really believed, what Moses said, you would believe me. He wrote of me.
- 46 If you believed Moses, you would believe me, for he wrote about me.
- 47 If you won't take seriously what he wrote, how can I expect you to take seriously what I speak?"
- 47 But since you do not believe what he wrote, how are you going to believe what I say?"

John 6

MSG

NIV

- 1 After this, Jesus went across the Sea of Galilee (some call it Tiberias).
- 1 Some time after this, Jesus crossed to the far shore of the Sea of Galilee (that is, the Sea of Tiberias),
- 2 A huge crowd followed him, attracted by the miracles they had seen him do among the sick.
- 2 and a great crowd of people followed him because they saw the miraculous signs he had performed on the sick.
- 3 When he got to the other side, he climbed a hill and sat down, surrounded by his disciples.
- 3 Then Jesus went up on a mountainside and sat down with his disciples.
- 4 It was nearly time for the Feast of Passover, kept annually by the Jews.
- 4 The Jewish Passover Feast was near.

- 5 When Jesus looked out and saw that a large crowd had arrived, he said to Philip, "Where can we buy bread to feed these people?"
- 5 When Jesus looked up and saw a great crowd coming toward him, he said to Philip, "Where shall we buy bread for these people to eat?"
- 6 He said this to stretch Philip's faith. He already knew what he was going to do.
- 6 He asked this only to test him, for he already had in mind what he was going to do.
- 7 Philip answered, "Two hundred silver pieces wouldn't be enough to buy bread for each person to get a piece."
- 7 Philip answered him, "Eight months' wages would not buy enough bread for each one to have a bite!"
- 8 One of the disciples--it was Andrew, brother to Simon Peter--said,
- 8 Another of his disciples, Andrew, Simon Peter's brother, spoke up,
- 9 "There's a little boy here who has five barley loaves and two fish. But that's a drop in the bucket for a crowd like this."
- 9 Here is a boy with five small barley loaves and two small fish, but how far will they go among so many?
- 10 Jesus said, "Make the people sit down." There was a nice carpet of green grass in this place. They sat down, about five thousand of them.
- 10 Jesus said, "Have the people sit down." There was plenty of grass in that place, and the men sat down, about five thousand of them.
- 11 Then Jesus took the bread and, having given thanks, gave it to those who were seated. He did the same with the fish. All ate as much as they wanted.
- 11 Jesus then took the loaves, gave thanks, and distributed to those who were seated as much as they wanted. He did the same with the fish.
- 12 When the people had eaten their fill, he said to his disciples, "Gather the leftovers so nothing is wasted."
- 12 When they had all had enough to eat, he said to his disciples, "Gather the pieces that are left over. Let nothing be wasted."
- 13 They went to work and filled twelve large baskets with leftovers from the five barley loaves.
- 13 So they gathered them and filled twelve baskets with the pieces of the five barley loaves left over by those who had eaten.

- 14 The people realized that God was at work among them in what Jesus had just done. They said, "This is the Prophet for sure, God's Prophet right here in Galilee!"
- 14 After the people saw the miraculous sign that Jesus did, they began to say, "Surely this is the Prophet who is to come into the world."
- 15 Jesus saw that in their enthusiasm, they were about to grab him and make him king, so he slipped off and went back up the mountain to be by himself.
- 15 Jesus, knowing that they intended to come and make him king by force, withdrew again to a mountain by himself.
- 16 In the evening his disciples went down to the sea,
- 16 When evening came, his disciples went down to the lake,
- 17 got in the boat, and headed back across the water to Capernaum. It had grown quite dark and Jesus had not yet returned.
- 17 where they got into a boat and set off across the lake for Capernaum. By now it was dark, and Jesus had not yet joined them.
- 18 A huge wind blew up, churning the sea.
- 18 A strong wind was blowing and the waters grew rough.
- 19 They were maybe three or four miles out when they saw Jesus walking on the sea, quite near the boat. They were scared senseless,
- 19 When they had rowed three or three and a half miles, they saw Jesus approaching the boat, walking on the water; and they were terrified.
- 20 but he reassured them, "It's me. It's all right. Don't be afraid."
- 20 But he said to them, "It is I; don't be afraid."
- 21 So they took him on board. In no time they reached land--the exact spot they were headed to.
- 21 Then they were willing to take him into the boat, and immediately the boat reached the shore where they were heading.
- 22 The next day the crowd that was left behind realized that there had been only one boat, and that Jesus had not gotten into it with his disciples. They had seen them go off without him.
- 22 The next day the crowd that had stayed on the opposite shore of the lake realized that only one boat had been there, and that Jesus had not entered it with his disciples, but that they had gone away alone.
- 23 By now boats from Tiberias had pulled up near where they had eaten the bread blessed by the Master.

- 23 Then some boats from Tiberias landed near the place where the people had eaten the bread after the Lord had given thanks.
- 24 So when the crowd realized he was gone and wasn't coming back, they piled into the Tiberias boats and headed for Capernaum, looking for Jesus.
- 24 Once the crowd realized that neither Jesus nor his disciples were there, they got into the boats and went to Capernaum in search of Jesus.
- 25 When they found him back across the sea, they said, "Rabbi, when did you get here?"
- 25 When they found him on the other side of the lake, they asked him, "Rabbi, when did you get here?"
- 26 Jesus answered, "You've come looking for me not because you saw God in my actions but because I fed you, filled your stomachs--and for free.
- 26 Jesus answered, "I tell you the truth, you are looking for me, not because you saw miraculous signs but because you ate the loaves and had your fill.
- 27 "Don't waste your energy striving for perishable food like that. Work for the food that sticks with you, food that nourishes your lasting life, food the Son of Man provides. He and what he does are guaranteed by God the Father to last."
- 27 Do not work for food that spoils, but for food that endures to eternal life, which the Son of Man will give you. On him God the Father has placed his seal of approval."
- 28 To that they said, "Well, what do we do then to get in on God's works?"
- 28 Then they asked him, "What must we do to do the works God requires?"
- 29 Jesus said, "Throw your lot in with the One that God has sent. That kind of a commitment gets you in on God's works."
- 29 Jesus answered, "The work of God is this: to believe in the one he has sent."
- 30 They waffled: "Why don't you give us a clue about who you are, just a hint of what's going on? When we see what's up, we'll commit ourselves. Show us what you can do.
- 30 So they asked him, "What miraculous sign then will you give that we may see it and believe you? What will you do?
- 31 Moses fed our ancestors with bread in the desert. It says so in the Scriptures: 'He gave them bread from heaven to eat.'"

31 Our forefathers ate the manna in the desert; as it is written: 'He gave them bread from heaven to eat.' "

32 Jesus responded, "The real significance of that Scripture is not that Moses gave you bread from heaven but that my Father is right now offering you bread from heaven, the real bread.

32 Jesus said to them, "I tell you the truth, it is not Moses who has given you the bread from heaven, but it is my Father who gives you the true bread from heaven.

33 The Bread of God came down out of heaven and is giving life to the world."

33 For the bread of God is he who comes down from heaven and gives life to the world."

34 They jumped at that: "Master, give us this bread, now and forever!"

34 Sir, they said, "from now on give us this bread."

35 Jesus said, "I am the Bread of Life. The person who aligns with me hungers no more and thirsts no more, ever.

35 Then Jesus declared, "I am the bread of life. He who comes to me will never go hungry, and he who believes in me will never be thirsty.

36 I have told you this explicitly because even though you have seen me in action, you don't really believe me.

36 But as I told you, you have seen me and still you do not believe.

37 Every person the Father gives me eventually comes running to me. And once that person is with me, I hold on and don't let go.

37 All that the Father gives me will come to me, and whoever comes to me I will never drive away.

38 I came down from heaven not to follow my own whim but to accomplish the will of the One who sent me.

38 For I have come down from heaven not to do my will but to do the will of him who sent me.

39 "This, in a nutshell, is that will: that everything handed over to me by the Father be completed--not a single detail missed--and at the wrap-up of time I have everything and everyone put together, upright and whole.

39 And this is the will of him who sent me, that I shall lose none of all that he has given me, but raise them up at the last day.

40 This is what my Father wants: that anyone who sees the Son and trusts who he is and what he does and then aligns with him will enter real life,

eternal life. My part is to put them on their feet alive and whole at the completion of time."

40 For my Father's will is that everyone who looks to the Son and believes in him shall have eternal life, and I will raise him up at the last day."

41 At this, because he said, "I am the Bread that came down from heaven," the Jews started arguing over him:

41 At this the Jews began to grumble about him because he said, "I am the bread that came down from heaven."

42 "Isn't this the son of Joseph? Don't we know his father? Don't we know his mother? How can he now say, 'I came down out of heaven' and expect anyone to believe him?"

42 They said, "Is this not Jesus, the son of Joseph, whose father and mother we know? How can he now say, 'I came down from heaven'?"

43 Jesus said, "Don't bicker among yourselves over me.

43 Stop grumbling among yourselves, Jesus answered.

44 You're not in charge here. The Father who sent me is in charge. He draws people to me--that's the only way you'll ever come. Only then do I do my work, putting people together, setting them on their feet, ready for the End.

44 No one can come to me unless the Father who sent me draws him, and I will raise him up at the last day.

45 This is what the prophets meant when they wrote, 'And then they will all be personally taught by God.' Anyone who has spent any time at all listening to the Father, really listening and therefore learning, comes to me to be taught personally--to see it with his own eyes, hear it with his own ears, from me, since I have it firsthand from the Father.

45 It is written in the Prophets: 'They will all be taught by God.' Everyone who listens to the Father and learns from him comes to me.

46 No one has seen the Father except the One who has his Being alongside the Father--and you can see me.

46 No one has seen the Father except the one who is from God; only he has seen the Father.

47 "I'm telling you the most solemn and sober truth now: Whoever believes in me has real life, eternal life.

47 I tell you the truth, he who believes has everlasting life.

48 I am the Bread of Life.

48 I am the bread of life.

49 Your ancestors ate the manna bread in the desert and died.

49 Your forefathers ate the manna in the desert, yet they died.

50 But now here is Bread that truly comes down out of heaven. Anyone eating this Bread will not die, ever.

50 But here is the bread that comes down from heaven, which a man may eat and not die.

51 I am the Bread--living Bread!--who came down out of heaven. Anyone who eats this Bread will live--and forever! The Bread that I present to the world so that it can eat and live is myself, this flesh-and-blood self."

51 I am the living bread that came down from heaven. If anyone eats of this bread, he will live forever. This bread is my flesh, which I will give for the life of the world."

52 At this, the Jews started fighting among themselves: "How can this man serve up his flesh for a meal?"

52 Then the Jews began to argue sharply among themselves, "How can this man give us his flesh to eat?"

53 But Jesus didn't give an inch. "Only insofar as you eat and drink flesh and blood, the flesh and blood of the Son of Man, do you have life within you.

53 Jesus said to them, "I tell you the truth, unless you eat the flesh of the Son of Man and drink his blood, you have no life in you.

54 The one who brings a hearty appetite to this eating and drinking has eternal life and will be fit and ready for the Final Day.

54 Whoever eats my flesh and drinks my blood has eternal life, and I will raise him up at the last day.

55 My flesh is real food and my blood is real drink.

55 For my flesh is real food and my blood is real drink.

56 By eating my flesh and drinking my blood you enter into me and I into you.

56 Whoever eats my flesh and drinks my blood remains in me, and I in him.

57 In the same way that the fully alive Father sent me here and I live because of him, so the one who makes a meal of me lives because of me.

57 Just as the living Father sent me and I live because of the Father, so the one who feeds on me will live because of me.

58 This is the Bread from heaven. Your ancestors ate bread and later died. Whoever eats this Bread will live always."

58 This is the bread that came down from heaven. Your forefathers ate manna and died, but he who feeds on this bread will live forever."

59 He said these things while teaching in the meeting place in Capernaum.

59 He said this while teaching in the synagogue in Capernaum.

60 Many among his disciples heard this and said, "This is tough teaching, too tough to swallow."

60 On hearing it, many of his disciples said, "This is a hard teaching. Who can accept it?"

61 Jesus sensed that his disciples were having a hard time with this and said, "Does this throw you completely?"

61 Aware that his disciples were grumbling about this, Jesus said to them, "Does this offend you?"

62 What would happen if you saw the Son of Man ascending to where he came from?

62 What if you see the Son of Man ascend to where he was before!

63 The Spirit can make life. Sheer muscle and willpower don't make anything happen. Every word I've spoken to you is a Spirit-word, and so it is life-making.

63 The Spirit gives life; the flesh counts for nothing. The words I have spoken to you are spirit and they are life.

64 But some of you are resisting, refusing to have any part in this." (Jesus knew from the start that some weren't going to risk themselves with him. He knew also who would betray him.)

64 Yet there are some of you who do not believe." For Jesus had known from the beginning which of them did not believe and who would betray him.

65 He went on to say, "This is why I told you earlier that no one is capable of coming to me on his own. You get to me only as a gift from the Father."

65 He went on to say, "This is why I told you that no one can come to me unless the Father has enabled him."

66 After this a lot of his disciples left. They no longer wanted to be associated with him.

- 66 From this time many of his disciples turned back and no longer followed him.
- 67 Then Jesus gave the Twelve their chance: "Do you also want to leave?"
- 67 You do not want to leave too, do you? Jesus asked the Twelve.
- 68 Peter replied, "Master, to whom would we go? You have the words of real life, eternal life.
- 68 Simon Peter answered him, "Lord, to whom shall we go? You have the words of eternal life.
- 69 We've already committed ourselves, confident that you are the Holy One of God."
- 69 We believe and know that you are the Holy One of God."
- 70 Jesus responded, "Haven't I handpicked you, the Twelve? Still, one of you is a devil!"
- 70 Then Jesus replied, "Have I not chosen you, the Twelve? Yet one of you is a devil!"
- 71 He was referring to Judas, son of Simon Iscariot. This man--one from the Twelve!--was even then getting ready to betray him.
- 71 (He meant Judas, the son of Simon Iscariot, who, though one of the Twelve, was later to betray him.)

John 7

MSG

NIV

- 1 Later Jesus was going about his business in Galilee. He didn't want to travel in Judea because the Jews there were looking for a chance to kill him.
- 1 After this, Jesus went around in Galilee, purposely staying away from Judea because the Jews there were waiting to take his life.
- 2 It was near the time of Tabernacles, a feast observed annually by the Jews.
- 2 But when the Jewish Feast of Tabernacles was near,
- 3 His brothers said, "Why don't you leave here and go up to the Feast so your disciples can get a good look at the works you do?"
- 3 Jesus' brothers said to him, "You ought to leave here and go to Judea, so that your disciples may see the miracles you do."

- 4 No one who intends to be publicly known does everything behind the scenes. If you're serious about what you are doing, come out in the open and show the world."
- 4 No one who wants to become a public figure acts in secret. Since you are doing these things, show yourself to the world."
- 5 His brothers were pushing him like this because they didn't believe in him either.
- 5 For even his own brothers did not believe in him.
- 6 Jesus came back at them, "Don't crowd me. This isn't my time. It's your time--it's always your time; you have nothing to lose.
- 6 Therefore Jesus told them, "The right time for me has not yet come; for you any time is right.
- 7 The world has nothing against you, but it's up in arms against me. It's against me because I expose the evil behind its pretensions.
- 7 The world cannot hate you, but it hates me because I testify that what it does is evil.
- 8 You go ahead, go up to the Feast. Don't wait for me. I'm not ready. It's not the right time for me."
- 8 You go to the Feast. I am not yet going up to this Feast, because for me the right time has not yet come."
- 9 He said this and stayed on in Galilee.
- 9 Having said this, he stayed in Galilee.
- 10 But later, after his family had gone up to the Feast, he also went. But he kept out of the way, careful not to draw attention to himself.
- 10 However, after his brothers had left for the Feast, he went also, not publicly, but in secret.
- 11 The Jews were already out looking for him, asking around, "Where is that man?"
- 11 Now at the Feast the Jews were watching for him and asking, "Where is that man?"
- 12 There was a lot of contentious talk about him circulating through the crowds. Some were saying, "He's a good man." But others said, "Not so. He's selling snake oil."
- 12 Among the crowds there was widespread whispering about him. Some said, "He is a good man." Others replied, "No, he deceives the people."

- 13 This kind of talk went on in guarded whispers because of the intimidating Jewish leaders.
- 13 But no one would say anything publicly about him for fear of the Jews.
- 14 With the Feast already half over, Jesus showed up in the Temple, teaching.
- 14 Not until halfway through the Feast did Jesus go up to the temple courts and begin to teach.
- 15 The Jews were impressed, but puzzled: "How does he know so much without being schooled?"
- 15 The Jews were amazed and asked, "How did this man get such learning without having studied?"
- 16 Jesus said, "I didn't make this up. What I teach comes from the One who sent me.
- 16 Jesus answered, "My teaching is not my own. It comes from him who sent me.
- 17 Anyone who wants to do his will can test this teaching and know whether it's from God or whether I'm making it up.
- 17 If anyone chooses to do God's will, he will find out whether my teaching comes from God or whether I speak on my own.
- 18 A person making things up tries to make himself look good. But someone trying to honor the one who sent him sticks to the facts and doesn't tamper with reality.
- 18 He who speaks on his own does so to gain honor for himself, but he who works for the honor of the one who sent him is a man of truth; there is nothing false about him.
- 19 It was Moses, wasn't it, who gave you God's Law? But none of you are living it. So why are you trying to kill me?"
- 19 Has not Moses given you the law? Yet not one of you keeps the law. Why are you trying to kill me?"
- 20 The crowd said, "You're crazy! Who's trying to kill you? You're demon-possessed."
- 20 You are demon-possessed, the crowd answered. "Who is trying to kill you?"
- 21 Jesus said, "I did one miraculous thing a few months ago, and you're still standing around getting all upset, wondering what I'm up to.
- 21 Jesus said to them, "I did one miracle, and you are all astonished.

- 22 Moses prescribed circumcision--originally it came not from Moses but from his ancestors--and so you circumcise a man, dealing with one part of his body, even if it's the Sabbath.
- 22 Yet, because Moses gave you circumcision (though actually it did not come from Moses, but from the patriarchs), you circumcise a child on the Sabbath.
- 23 You do this in order to preserve one item in the Law of Moses. So why are you upset with me because I made a man's whole body well on the Sabbath?
- 23 Now if a child can be circumcised on the Sabbath so that the law of Moses may not be broken, why are you angry with me for healing the whole man on the Sabbath?
- 24 Don't be nitpickers; use your head--and heart!--to discern what is right, to test what is authentically right."
- 24 Stop judging by mere appearances, and make a right judgment."
- 25 That's when some of the people of Jerusalem said, "Isn't this the one they were out to kill?
- 25 At that point some of the people of Jerusalem began to ask, "Isn't this the man they are trying to kill?
- 26 And here he is out in the open, saying whatever he pleases, and no one is stopping him. Could it be that the rulers know that he is, in fact, the Messiah?
- 26 Here he is, speaking publicly, and they are not saying a word to him. Have the authorities really concluded that he is the Christ?
- 27 And yet we know where this man came from. The Messiah is going to come out of nowhere. Nobody is going to know where he comes from."
- 27 But we know where this man is from; when the Christ comes, no one will know where he is from."
- 28 That provoked Jesus, who was teaching in the Temple, to cry out, "Yes, you think you know me and where I'm from, but that's not where I'm from. I didn't set myself up in business. My true origin is in the One who sent me, and you don't know him at all.
- 28 Then Jesus, still teaching in the temple courts, cried out, "Yes, you know me, and you know where I am from. I am not here on my own, but he who sent me is true. You do not know him,
- 29 I come from him--that's how I know him. He sent me here."

29 but I know him because I am from him and he sent me."

30 They were looking for a way to arrest him, but not a hand was laid on him because it wasn't yet God's time.

30 At this they tried to seize him, but no one laid a hand on him, because his time had not yet come.

31 Many from the crowd committed themselves in faith to him, saying, "Will the Messiah, when he comes, provide better or more convincing evidence than this?"

31 Still, many in the crowd put their faith in him. They said, "When the Christ comes, will he do more miraculous signs than this man?"

32 The Pharisees, alarmed at this seditious undertow going through the crowd, teamed up with the high priests and sent their police to arrest him.

32 The Pharisees heard the crowd whispering such things about him. Then the chief priests and the Pharisees sent temple guards to arrest him.

33 Jesus rebuffed them: "I am with you only a short time. Then I go on to the One who sent me.

33 Jesus said, "I am with you for only a short time, and then I go to the one who sent me.

34 You will look for me, but you won't find me. Where I am, you can't come."

34 You will look for me, but you will not find me; and where I am, you cannot come."

35 The Jews put their heads together. "Where do you think he is going that we won't be able to find him? Do you think he is about to travel to the Greek world to teach the Jews?

35 The Jews said to one another, "Where does this man intend to go that we cannot find him? Will he go where our people live scattered among the Greeks, and teach the Greeks?

36 What is he talking about, anyway: 'You will look for me, but you won't find me,' and 'Where I am, you can't come'?"

36 What did he mean when he said, 'You will look for me, but you will not find me,' and 'Where I am, you cannot come'?"

37 On the final and climactic day of the Feast, Jesus took his stand. He cried out, "If anyone thirsts, let him come to me and drink.

- 37 On the last and greatest day of the Feast, Jesus stood and said in a loud voice, "If anyone is thirsty, let him come to me and drink.
- 38 Rivers of living water will brim and spill out of the depths of anyone who believes in me this way, just as the Scripture says."
- 38 Whoever believes in me, as the Scripture has said, streams of living water will flow from within him."
- 39 (He said this in regard to the Spirit, whom those who believed in him were about to receive. The Spirit had not yet been given because Jesus had not yet been glorified.)
- 39 By this he meant the Spirit, whom those who believed in him were later to receive. Up to that time the Spirit had not been given, since Jesus had not yet been glorified.
- 40 Those in the crowd who heard these words were saying, "This has to be the Prophet."
- 40 On hearing his words, some of the people said, "Surely this man is the Prophet."
- 41 Others said, "He is the Messiah!" But others were saying, "The Messiah doesn't come from Galilee, does he?"
- 41 Others said, "He is the Christ." Still others asked, "How can the Christ come from Galilee?"
- 42 Don't the Scriptures tell us that the Messiah comes from David's line and from Bethlehem, David's village?"
- 42 Does not the Scripture say that the Christ will come from David's family and from Bethlehem, the town where David lived?"
- 43 So there was a split in the crowd over him.
- 43 Thus the people were divided because of Jesus.
- 44 Some went so far as wanting to arrest him, but no one laid a hand on him.
- 44 Some wanted to seize him, but no one laid a hand on him.
- 45 That's when the Temple police reported back to the high priests and Pharisees, who demanded, "Why didn't you bring him with you?"
- 45 Finally the temple guards went back to the chief priests and Pharisees, who asked them, "Why didn't you bring him in?"
- 46 The police answered, "Have you heard the way he talks? We've never heard anyone speak like this man."
- 46 No one ever spoke the way this man does, the guards declared.

47 The Pharisees said, "Are you carried away like the rest of the rabble?
47 You mean he has deceived you also? the Pharisees retorted.
48 You don't see any of the leaders believing in him, do you? Or any from
the Pharisees?
48 Has any of the rulers or of the Pharisees believed in him?
49 It's only this crowd, ignorant of God's Law, that is taken in by him--and
damned."
49 No! But this mob that knows nothing of the law--there is a curse on
them."
50 Nicodemus, the man who had come to Jesus earlier and was both a ruler
and a Pharisee, spoke up.
50 Nicodemus, who had gone to Jesus earlier and who was one of their
own number, asked,
51 "Does our Law decide about a man's guilt without first listening to him
and finding out what he is doing?"
51 Does our law condemn anyone without first hearing him to find out
what he is doing?
52 But they cut him off. "Are you also campaigning for the Galilean?
52 They replied, "Are you from Galilee, too? Look into it, and you will
find that a prophet does not come out of Galilee."
53 Examine the evidence. See if any prophet ever comes from Galilee."
Then they all went home.
53 Then each went to his own home.

John 8

MSG

NIV

1 Jesus went across to Mount Olives,
1 But Jesus went to the Mount of Olives.
2 but he was soon back in the Temple again. Swarms of people came to
him. He sat down and taught them.
2 At dawn he appeared again in the temple courts, where all the people
gathered around him, and he sat down to teach them.
3 The religion scholars and Pharisees led in a woman who had been caught
in an act of adultery. They stood her in plain sight of everyone

- 3 The teachers of the law and the Pharisees brought in a woman caught in adultery. They made her stand before the group
- 4 and said, "Teacher, this woman was caught red-handed in the act of adultery.
- 4 and said to Jesus, "Teacher, this woman was caught in the act of adultery.
- 5 Moses, in the Law, gives orders to stone such persons. What do you say?"
- 5 In the Law Moses commanded us to stone such women. Now what do you say?"
- 6 They were trying to trap him into saying something incriminating so they could bring charges against him. Jesus bent down and wrote with his finger in the dirt.
- 6 They were using this question as a trap, in order to have a basis for accusing him. But Jesus bent down and started to write on the ground with his finger.
- 7 They kept at him, badgering him. He straightened up and said, "The sinless one among you, go first: Throw the stone."
- 7 When they kept on questioning him, he straightened up and said to them, "If any one of you is without sin, let him be the first to throw a stone at her."
- 8 Bending down again, he wrote some more in the dirt.
- 8 Again he stooped down and wrote on the ground.
- 9 Hearing that, they walked away, one after another, beginning with the oldest. The woman was left alone.
- 9 At this, those who heard began to go away one at a time, the older ones first, until only Jesus was left, with the woman still standing there.
- 10 Jesus stood up and spoke to her. "Woman, where are they? Does no one condemn you?"
- 10 Jesus straightened up and asked her, "Woman, where are they? Has no one condemned you?"
- 11 "No one, Master." "Neither do I," said Jesus. "Go on your way. From now on, don't sin."
- 11 No one, sir, she said. "Then neither do I condemn you," Jesus declared. "Go now and leave your life of sin."
- 12 Jesus once again addressed them: "I am the world's Light. No one who follows me stumbles around in the darkness. I provide plenty of light to

live in."

12 When Jesus spoke again to the people, he said, "I am the light of the world. Whoever follows me will never walk in darkness, but will have the light of life."

13 The Pharisees objected, "All we have is your word on this. We need more than this to go on."

13 The Pharisees challenged him, "Here you are, appearing as your own witness; your testimony is not valid."

14 Jesus replied, "You're right that you only have my word. But you can depend on it being true. I know where I've come from and where I go next. You don't know where I'm from or where I'm headed."

14 Jesus answered, "Even if I testify on my own behalf, my testimony is valid, for I know where I came from and where I am going. But you have no idea where I come from or where I am going."

15 You decide according to what you can see and touch. I don't make judgments like that.

15 You judge by human standards; I pass judgment on no one.

16 But even if I did, my judgment would be true because I wouldn't make it out of the narrowness of my experience but in the largeness of the One who sent me, the Father.

16 But if I do judge, my decisions are right, because I am not alone. I stand with the Father, who sent me.

17 That fulfills the conditions set down in God's Law: that you can count on the testimony of two witnesses.

17 In your own Law it is written that the testimony of two men is valid.

18 And that is what you have: You have my word and you have the word of the Father who sent me."

18 I am one who testifies for myself; my other witness is the Father, who sent me."

19 They said, "Where is this so-called Father of yours?" Jesus said, "You're looking right at me and you don't see me. How do you expect to see the Father? If you knew me, you would at the same time know the Father."

19 Then they asked him, "Where is your father?" "You do not know me or my Father," Jesus replied. "If you knew me, you would know my Father also."

20 He gave this speech in the Treasury while teaching in the Temple. No one arrested him because his time wasn't yet up.

20 He spoke these words while teaching in the temple area near the place where the offerings were put. Yet no one seized him, because his time had not yet come.

21 Then he went over the same ground again. "I'm leaving and you are going to look for me, but you're missing God in this and are headed for a dead end. There is no way you can come with me."

21 Once more Jesus said to them, "I am going away, and you will look for me, and you will die in your sin. Where I go, you cannot come."

22 The Jews said, "So, is he going to kill himself? Is that what he means by 'You can't come with me'?"

22 This made the Jews ask, "Will he kill himself? Is that why he says, 'Where I go, you cannot come'?"

23 Jesus said, "You're tied down to the mundane; I'm in touch with what is beyond your horizons. You live in terms of what you see and touch. I'm living on other terms.

23 But he continued, "You are from below; I am from above. You are of this world; I am not of this world.

24 I told you that you were missing God in all this. You're at a dead end. If you won't believe I am who I say I am, you're at the dead end of sins. You're missing God in your lives."

24 I told you that you would die in your sins; if you do not believe that I am the one I claim to be, you will indeed die in your sins."

25 They said to him, "Just who are you anyway?" Jesus said, "What I've said from the start.

25 Who are you? they asked. "Just what I have been claiming all along," Jesus replied.

26 I have so many things to say that concern you, judgments to make that affect you, but if you don't accept the trustworthiness of the One who commanded my words and acts, none of it matters. That is who you are questioning--not me but the One who sent me."

26 I have much to say in judgment of you. But he who sent me is reliable, and what I have heard from him I tell the world.

27 They still didn't get it, didn't realize that he was referring to the Father.

27 They did not understand that he was telling them about his Father.

28 So Jesus tried again. "When you raise up the Son of Man, then you will know who I am--that I'm not making this up, but speaking only what the Father taught me.

28 So Jesus said, "When you have lifted up the Son of Man, then you will know that I am the one I claim to be and that I do nothing on my own but speak just what the Father has taught me.

29 The One who sent me stays with me. He doesn't abandon me. He sees how much joy I take in pleasing him."

29 The one who sent me is with me; he has not left me alone, for I always do what pleases him."

30 When he put it in these terms, many people decided to believe.

30 Even as he spoke, many put their faith in him.

31 Then Jesus turned to the Jews who had claimed to believe in him. "If you stick with this, living out what I tell you, you are my disciples for sure.

31 To the Jews who had believed him, Jesus said, "If you hold to my teaching, you are really my disciples.

32 Then you will experience for yourselves the truth, and the truth will free you."

32 Then you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free."

33 Surprised, they said, "But we're descendants of Abraham. We've never been slaves to anyone. How can you say, 'The truth will free you'?"

33 They answered him, "We are Abraham's descendants and have never been slaves of anyone. How can you say that we shall be set free?"

34 Jesus said, "I tell you most solemnly that anyone who chooses a life of sin is trapped in a dead-end life and is, in fact, a slave.

34 Jesus replied, "I tell you the truth, everyone who sins is a slave to sin.

35 A slave is a transient, who can't come and go at will. The Son, though, has an established position, the run of the house.

35 Now a slave has no permanent place in the family, but a son belongs to it forever.

36 So if the Son sets you free, you are free through and through.

36 So if the Son sets you free, you will be free indeed.

37 I know you are Abraham's descendants. But I also know that you are trying to kill me because my message hasn't yet penetrated your thick skulls.

- 37 I know you are Abraham's descendants. Yet you are ready to kill me, because you have no room for my word.
- 38 I'm talking about things I have seen while keeping company with the Father, and you just go on doing what you have heard from your father."
- 38 I am telling you what I have seen in the Father's presence, and you do what you have heard from your father. "
- 39 They were indignant. "Our father is Abraham!" Jesus said, "If you were Abraham's children, you would have been doing the things Abraham did.
- 39 Abraham is our father, they answered. "If you were Abraham's children," said Jesus, "then you would do the things Abraham did.
- 40 And yet here you are trying to kill me, a man who has spoken to you the truth he got straight from God! Abraham never did that sort of thing.
- 40 As it is, you are determined to kill me, a man who has told you the truth that I heard from God. Abraham did not do such things.
- 41 You persist in repeating the works of your father." They said, "We're not bastards. We have a legitimate father: the one and only God."
- 41 You are doing the things your own father does." "We are not illegitimate children," they protested. "The only Father we have is God himself."
- 42 "If God was your father," said Jesus, "you would love me, for I came from God and arrived here. I didn't come on my own. He sent me.
- 42 Jesus said to them, "If God were your Father, you would love me, for I came from God and now am here. I have not come on my own; but he sent me.
- 43 Why can't you understand one word I say? Here's why: You can't handle it.
- 43 Why is my language not clear to you? Because you are unable to hear what I say.
- 44 You're from your father, the Devil, and all you want to do is please him. He was a killer from the very start. He couldn't stand the truth because there wasn't a shred of truth in him. When the Liar speaks, he makes it up out of his lying nature and fills the world with lies.
- 44 You belong to your father, the devil, and you want to carry out your father's desire. He was a murderer from the beginning, not holding to the truth, for there is no truth in him. When he lies, he speaks his native language, for he is a liar and the father of lies.

45 I arrive on the scene, tell you the plain truth, and you refuse to have a thing to do with me.

45 Yet because I tell the truth, you do not believe me!

46 Can any one of you convict me of a single misleading word, a single sinful act? But if I'm telling the truth, why don't you believe me?

46 Can any of you prove me guilty of sin? If I am telling the truth, why don't you believe me?

47 Anyone on God's side listens to God's words. This is why you're not listening--because you're not on God's side."

47 He who belongs to God hears what God says. The reason you do not hear is that you do not belong to God."

48 The Jews then said, "That clinches it. We were right all along when we called you a Samaritan and said you were crazy--demon-possessed!"

48 The Jews answered him, "Aren't we right in saying that you are a Samaritan and demon-possessed?"

49 Jesus said, "I'm not crazy. I simply honor my Father, while you dishonor me.

49 I am not possessed by a demon, said Jesus, "but I honor my Father and you dishonor me.

50 I am not trying to get anything for myself. God intends something gloriously grand here and is making the decisions that will bring it about.

50 I am not seeking glory for myself; but there is one who seeks it, and he is the judge.

51 I say this with absolute confidence. If you practice what I'm telling you, you'll never have to look death in the face."

51 I tell you the truth, if anyone keeps my word, he will never see death."

52 At this point the Jews said, "Now we know you're crazy. Abraham died. The prophets died. And you show up saying, 'If you practice what I'm telling you, you'll never have to face death, not even a taste.'

52 At this the Jews exclaimed, "Now we know that you are demon-possessed! Abraham died and so did the prophets, yet you say that if anyone keeps your word, he will never taste death.

53 Are you greater than Abraham, who died? And the prophets died! Who do you think you are!"

53 Are you greater than our father Abraham? He died, and so did the prophets. Who do you think you are?"

54 Jesus said, "If I turned the spotlight on myself, it wouldn't amount to anything. But my Father, the same One you say is your Father, put me here at this time and place of splendor.

54 Jesus replied, "If I glorify myself, my glory means nothing. My Father, whom you claim as your God, is the one who glorifies me.

55 You haven't recognized him in this. But I have. If I, in false modesty, said I didn't know what was going on, I would be as much of a liar as you are. But I do know, and I am doing what he says.

55 Though you do not know him, I know him. If I said I did not, I would be a liar like you, but I do know him and keep his word.

56 Abraham--your 'father'--with jubilant faith looked down the corridors of history and saw my day coming. He saw it and cheered."

56 Your father Abraham rejoiced at the thought of seeing my day; he saw it and was glad."

57 The Jews said, "You're not even fifty years old--and Abraham saw you?"

57 You are not yet fifty years old, the Jews said to him, "and you have seen Abraham!"

58 "Believe me," said Jesus, "I am who I am long before Abraham was anything."

58 I tell you the truth, Jesus answered, "before Abraham was born, I am!"

59 That did it--pushed them over the edge. They picked up rocks to throw at him. But Jesus slipped away, getting out of the Temple.

59 At this, they picked up stones to stone him, but Jesus hid himself, slipping away from the temple grounds.

John 9

MSG

NIV

- 1 Walking down the street, Jesus saw a man blind from birth.
- 1 As he went along, he saw a man blind from birth.
- 2 His disciples asked, "Rabbi, who sinned: this man or his parents, causing him to be born blind?"
- 2 His disciples asked him, "Rabbi, who sinned, this man or his parents, that he was born blind?"

- 3 Jesus said, "You're asking the wrong question. You're looking for someone to blame. There is no such cause-effect here. Look instead for what God can do.
- 3 Neither this man nor his parents sinned, said Jesus, "but this happened so that the work of God might be displayed in his life.
- 4 We need to be energetically at work for the One who sent me here, working while the sun shines. When night falls, the workday is over.
- 4 As long as it is day, we must do the work of him who sent me. Night is coming, when no one can work.
- 5 For as long as I am in the world, there is plenty of light. I am the world's Light."
- 5 While I am in the world, I am the light of the world."
- 6 He said this and then spit in the dust, made a clay paste with the saliva, rubbed the paste on the blind man's eyes,
- 6 Having said this, he spit on the ground, made some mud with the saliva, and put it on the man's eyes.
- 7 and said, "Go, wash at the Pool of Siloam" (Siloam means "Sent"). The man went and washed--and saw.
- 7 Go, he told him, "wash in the Pool of Siloam" (this word means Sent). So the man went and washed, and came home seeing.
- 8 Soon the town was buzzing. His relatives and those who year after year had seen him as a blind man begging were saying, "Why, isn't this the man we knew, who sat here and begged?"
- 8 His neighbors and those who had formerly seen him begging asked, "Isn't this the same man who used to sit and beg?"
- 9 Others said, "It's him all right!" But others objected, "It's not the same man at all. It just looks like him." He said, "It's me, the very one."
- 9 Some claimed that he was. Others said, "No, he only looks like him." But he himself insisted, "I am the man."
- 10 They said, "How did your eyes get opened?"
- 10 How then were your eyes opened? they demanded.
- 11 "A man named Jesus made a paste and rubbed it on my eyes and told me, 'Go to Siloam and wash.' I did what he said. When I washed, I saw."
- 11 He replied, "The man they call Jesus made some mud and put it on my eyes. He told me to go to Siloam and wash. So I went and washed, and then I could see."

12 "So where is he?" "I don't know."

12 Where is this man? they asked him. "I don't know," he said.

13 They marched the man to the Pharisees.

13 They brought to the Pharisees the man who had been blind.

14 This day when Jesus made the paste and healed his blindness was the Sabbath.

14 Now the day on which Jesus had made the mud and opened the man's eyes was a Sabbath.

15 The Pharisees grilled him again on how he had come to see. He said, "He put a clay paste on my eyes, and I washed, and now I see."

15 Therefore the Pharisees also asked him how he had received his sight. "He put mud on my eyes," the man replied, "and I washed, and now I see."

16 Some of the Pharisees said, "Obviously, this man can't be from God. He doesn't keep the Sabbath." Others countered, "How can a bad man do miraculous, God-revealing things like this?" There was a split in their ranks.

16 Some of the Pharisees said, "This man is not from God, for he does not keep the Sabbath." But others asked, "How can a sinner do such miraculous signs?" So they were divided.

17 They came back at the blind man, "You're the expert. He opened your eyes. What do you say about him?" He said, "He is a prophet."

17 Finally they turned again to the blind man, "What have you to say about him? It was your eyes he opened." The man replied, "He is a prophet."

18 The Jews didn't believe it, didn't believe the man was blind to begin with. So they called the parents of the man now bright-eyed with sight.

18 The Jews still did not believe that he had been blind and had received his sight until they sent for the man's parents.

19 They asked them, "Is this your son, the one you say was born blind? So how is it that he now sees?"

19 Is this your son? they asked. "Is this the one you say was born blind? How is it that now he can see?"

20 His parents said, "We know he is our son, and we know he was born blind.

20 We know he is our son, the parents answered, "and we know he was born blind.

- 21 But we don't know how he came to see--haven't a clue about who opened his eyes. Why don't you ask him? He's a grown man and can speak for himself."
- 21 But how he can see now, or who opened his eyes, we don't know. Ask him. He is of age; he will speak for himself."
- 22 (His parents were talking like this because they were intimidated by the Jewish leaders, who had already decided that anyone who took a stand that this was the Messiah would be kicked out of the meeting place.
- 22 His parents said this because they were afraid of the Jews, for already the Jews had decided that anyone who acknowledged that Jesus was the Christ would be put out of the synagogue.
- 23 That's why his parents said, "Ask him. He's a grown man.")
- 23 That was why his parents said, "He is of age; ask him."
- 24 They called the man back a second time--the man who had been blind--and told him, "Give credit to God. We know this man is an impostor."
- 24 A second time they summoned the man who had been blind. "Give glory to God, " they said. "We know this man is a sinner."
- 25 He replied, "I know nothing about that one way or the other. But I know one thing for sure: I was blind . . . I now see."
- 25 He replied, "Whether he is a sinner or not, I don't know. One thing I do know. I was blind but now I see!"
- 26 They said, "What did he do to you? How did he open your eyes?"
- 26 Then they asked him, "What did he do to you? How did he open your eyes?"
- 27 "I've told you over and over and you haven't listened. Why do you want to hear it again? Are you so eager to become his disciples?"
- 27 He answered, "I have told you already and you did not listen. Why do you want to hear it again? Do you want to become his disciples, too?"
- 28 With that they jumped all over him. "You might be a disciple of that man, but we're disciples of Moses.
- 28 Then they hurled insults at him and said, "You are this fellow's disciple! We are disciples of Moses!
- 29 We know for sure that God spoke to Moses, but we have no idea where this man even comes from."
- 29 We know that God spoke to Moses, but as for this fellow, we don't even know where he comes from."

30 The man replied, "This is amazing! You claim to know nothing about him, but the fact is, he opened my eyes!"

30 The man answered, "Now that is remarkable! You don't know where he comes from, yet he opened my eyes."

31 It's well known that God isn't at the beck and call of sinners, but listens carefully to anyone who lives in reverence and does his will.

31 We know that God does not listen to sinners. He listens to the godly man who does his will.

32 That someone opened the eyes of a man born blind has never been heard of--ever.

32 Nobody has ever heard of opening the eyes of a man born blind.

33 If this man didn't come from God, he wouldn't be able to do anything."

33 If this man were not from God, he could do nothing."

34 They said, "You're nothing but dirt! How dare you take that tone with us!" Then they threw him out in the street.

34 To this they replied, "You were steeped in sin at birth; how dare you lecture us!" And they threw him out.

35 Jesus heard that they had thrown him out, and went and found him. He asked him, "Do you believe in the Son of Man?"

35 Jesus heard that they had thrown him out, and when he found him, he said, "Do you believe in the Son of Man?"

36 The man said, "Point him out to me, sir, so that I can believe in him."

36 Who is he, sir? the man asked. "Tell me so that I may believe in him."

37 Jesus said, "You're looking right at him. Don't you recognize my voice?"

37 Jesus said, "You have now seen him; in fact, he is the one speaking with you."

38 "Master, I believe," the man said, and worshiped him.

38 Then the man said, "Lord, I believe," and he worshiped him.

39 Jesus then said, "I came into the world to bring everything into the clear light of day, making all the distinctions clear, so that those who have never seen will see, and those who have made a great pretense of seeing will be exposed as blind."

39 Jesus said, "For judgment I have come into this world, so that the blind will see and those who see will become blind."

- 40 Some Pharisees overheard him and said, "Does that mean you're calling us blind?"
- 40 Some Pharisees who were with him heard him say this and asked, "What? Are we blind too?"
- 41 Jesus said, "If you were really blind, you would be blameless, but since you claim to see everything so well, you're accountable for every fault and failure.
- 41 Jesus said, "If you were blind, you would not be guilty of sin; but now that you claim you can see, your guilt remains.

John 10

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Let me set this before you as plainly as I can. If a person climbs over or through the fence of a sheep pen instead of going through the gate, you know he's up to no good--a sheep rustler!
- 1 I tell you the truth, the man who does not enter the sheep pen by the gate, but climbs in by some other way, is a thief and a robber.
- 2 The shepherd walks right up to the gate.
- 2 The man who enters by the gate is the shepherd of his sheep.
- 3 The gatekeeper opens the gate to him and the sheep recognize his voice. He calls his own sheep by name and leads them out.
- 3 The watchman opens the gate for him, and the sheep listen to his voice. He calls his own sheep by name and leads them out.
- 4 When he gets them all out, he leads them and they follow because they are familiar with his voice.
- 4 When he has brought out all his own, he goes on ahead of them, and his sheep follow him because they know his voice.
- 5 They won't follow a stranger's voice but will scatter because they aren't used to the sound of it."
- 5 But they will never follow a stranger; in fact, they will run away from him because they do not recognize a stranger's voice."
- 6 Jesus told this simple story, but they had no idea what he was talking about.

- 6 Jesus used this figure of speech, but they did not understand what he was telling them.
- 7 So he tried again. "I'll be explicit, then. I am the Gate for the sheep.
- 7 Therefore Jesus said again, "I tell you the truth, I am the gate for the sheep.
- 8 All those others are up to no good--sheep stealers, every one of them. But the sheep didn't listen to them.
- 8 All who ever came before me were thieves and robbers, but the sheep did not listen to them.
- 9 I am the Gate. Anyone who goes through me will be cared for--will freely go in and out, and find pasture.
- 9 I am the gate; whoever enters through me will be saved. He will come in and go out, and find pasture.
- 10 A thief is only there to steal and kill and destroy. I came so they can have real and eternal life, more and better life than they ever dreamed of.
- 10 The thief comes only to steal and kill and destroy; I have come that they may have life, and have it to the full.
- 11 "I am the Good Shepherd. The Good Shepherd puts the sheep before himself, sacrifices himself if necessary.
- 11 I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down his life for the sheep.
- 12 A hired man is not a real shepherd. The sheep mean nothing to him. He sees a wolf come and runs for it, leaving the sheep to be ravaged and scattered by the wolf.
- 12 The hired hand is not the shepherd who owns the sheep. So when he sees the wolf coming, he abandons the sheep and runs away. Then the wolf attacks the flock and scatters it.
- 13 He's only in it for the money. The sheep don't matter to him.
- 13 The man runs away because he is a hired hand and cares nothing for the sheep.
- 14 "I am the Good Shepherd. I know my own sheep and my own sheep know me.
- 14 I am the good shepherd; I know my sheep and my sheep know me--
- 15 In the same way, the Father knows me and I know the Father. I put the sheep before myself, sacrificing myself if necessary.

- 15 just as the Father knows me and I know the Father--and I lay down my life for the sheep.
- 16 You need to know that I have other sheep in addition to those in this pen. I need to gather and bring them, too. They'll also recognize my voice. Then it will be one flock, one Shepherd.
- 16 I have other sheep that are not of this sheep pen. I must bring them also. They too will listen to my voice, and there shall be one flock and one shepherd.
- 17 This is why the Father loves me: because I freely lay down my life. And so I am free to take it up again.
- 17 The reason my Father loves me is that I lay down my life--only to take it up again.
- 18 No one takes it from me. I lay it down of my own free will. I have the right to lay it down; I also have the right to take it up again. I received this authority personally from my Father."
- 18 No one takes it from me, but I lay it down of my own accord. I have authority to lay it down and authority to take it up again. This command I received from my Father."
- 19 This kind of talk caused another split in the Jewish ranks.
- 19 At these words the Jews were again divided.
- 20 A lot of them were saying, "He's crazy, a maniac--out of his head completely. Why bother listening to him?"
- 20 Many of them said, "He is demon-possessed and raving mad. Why listen to him?"
- 21 But others weren't so sure: "These aren't the words of a crazy man. Can a 'maniac' open blind eyes?"
- 21 But others said, "These are not the sayings of a man possessed by a demon. Can a demon open the eyes of the blind?"
- 22 They were celebrating Hanukkah just then in Jerusalem. It was winter.
- 22 Then came the Feast of Dedication at Jerusalem. It was winter,
- 23 Jesus was strolling in the Temple across Solomon's Porch.
- 23 and Jesus was in the temple area walking in Solomon's Colonnade.
- 24 The Jews, circling him, said, "How long are you going to keep us guessing? If you're the Messiah, tell us straight out."
- 24 The Jews gathered around him, saying, "How long will you keep us in suspense? If you are the Christ, tell us plainly."

25 Jesus answered, "I told you, but you don't believe. Everything I have done has been authorized by my Father, actions that speak louder than words.

25 Jesus answered, "I did tell you, but you do not believe. The miracles I do in my Father's name speak for me,

26 You don't believe because you're not my sheep.

26 but you do not believe because you are not my sheep.

27 My sheep recognize my voice. I know them, and they follow me.

27 My sheep listen to my voice; I know them, and they follow me.

28 I give them real and eternal life. They are protected from the Destroyer for good. No one can steal them from out of my hand.

28 I give them eternal life, and they shall never perish; no one can snatch them out of my hand.

29 The Father who put them under my care is so much greater than the Destroyer and Thief. No one could ever get them away from him.

29 My Father, who has given them to me, is greater than all; no one can snatch them out of my Father's hand.

30 I and the Father are one heart and mind."

30 I and the Father are one."

31 Again the Jews picked up rocks to throw at him.

31 Again the Jews picked up stones to stone him,

32 Jesus said, "I have made a present to you from the Father of a great many good actions. For which of these acts do you stone me?"

32 but Jesus said to them, "I have shown you many great miracles from the Father. For which of these do you stone me?"

33 The Jews said, "We're not stoning you for anything good you did, but for what you said--this blasphemy of calling yourself God."

33 We are not stoning you for any of these, replied the Jews, "but for blasphemy, because you, a mere man, claim to be God."

34 Jesus said, "I'm only quoting your inspired Scriptures, where God said, 'I tell you--you are gods.'

34 Jesus answered them, "Is it not written in your Law, 'I have said you are gods' ?

35 If God called your ancestors 'gods'--and Scripture doesn't lie--

35 If he called them 'gods,' to whom the word of God came--and the Scripture cannot be broken--

- 36 why do you yell, 'Blasphemer! Blasphemer!' at the unique One the Father consecrated and sent into the world, just because I said, 'I am the Son of God'?
- 36 what about the one whom the Father set apart as his very own and sent into the world? Why then do you accuse me of blasphemy because I said, 'I am God's Son'?
- 37 If I don't do the things my Father does, well and good; don't believe me.
- 37 Do not believe me unless I do what my Father does.
- 38 But if I am doing them, put aside for a moment what you hear me say about myself and just take the evidence of the actions that are right before your eyes. Then perhaps things will come together for you, and you'll see that not only are we doing the same thing, we are the same-- Father and Son. He is in me; I am in him."
- 38 But if I do it, even though you do not believe me, believe the miracles, that you may know and understand that the Father is in me, and I in the Father."
- 39 They tried yet again to arrest him, but he slipped through their fingers.
- 39 Again they tried to seize him, but he escaped their grasp.
- 40 He went back across the Jordan to the place where John first baptized, and stayed there.
- 40 Then Jesus went back across the Jordan to the place where John had been baptizing in the early days. Here he stayed
- 41 A lot of people followed him over. They were saying, "John did no miracles, but everything he said about this man has come true."
- 41 and many people came to him. They said, "Though John never performed a miraculous sign, all that John said about this man was true."
- 42 Many believed in him then and there.
- 42 And in that place many believed in Jesus.

John 11

MSG

NIV

- 1 A man was sick, Lazarus of Bethany, the town of Mary and her sister Martha.

- 1 Now a man named Lazarus was sick. He was from Bethany, the village of Mary and her sister Martha.
- 2 This was the same Mary who massaged the Lord's feet with aromatic oils and then wiped them with her hair. It was her brother Lazarus who was sick.
- 2 This Mary, whose brother Lazarus now lay sick, was the same one who poured perfume on the Lord and wiped his feet with her hair.
- 3 So the sisters sent word to Jesus, "Master, the one you love so very much is sick."
- 3 So the sisters sent word to Jesus, "Lord, the one you love is sick."
- 4 When Jesus got the message, he said, "This sickness is not fatal. It will become an occasion to show God's glory by glorifying God's Son."
- 4 When he heard this, Jesus said, "This sickness will not end in death. No, it is for God's glory so that God's Son may be glorified through it."
- 5 Jesus loved Martha and her sister and Lazarus,
- 5 Jesus loved Martha and her sister and Lazarus.
- 6 but oddly, when he heard that Lazarus was sick, he stayed on where he was for two more days.
- 6 Yet when he heard that Lazarus was sick, he stayed where he was two more days.
- 7 After the two days, he said to his disciples, "Let's go back to Judea."
- 7 Then he said to his disciples, "Let us go back to Judea."
- 8 They said, "Rabbi, you can't do that. The Jews are out to kill you, and you're going back?"
- 8 But Rabbi, they said, "a short while ago the Jews tried to stone you, and yet you are going back there?"
- 9 Jesus replied, "Are there not twelve hours of daylight? Anyone who walks in daylight doesn't stumble because there's plenty of light from the sun.
- 9 Jesus answered, "Are there not twelve hours of daylight? A man who walks by day will not stumble, for he sees by this world's light.
- 10 Walking at night, he might very well stumble because he can't see where he's going."
- 10 It is when he walks by night that he stumbles, for he has no light."
- 11 He said these things, and then announced, "Our friend Lazarus has fallen asleep. I'm going to wake him up."

11 After he had said this, he went on to tell them, "Our friend Lazarus has fallen asleep; but I am going there to wake him up."

12 The disciples said, "Master, if he's gone to sleep, he'll get a good rest and wake up feeling fine."

12 His disciples replied, "Lord, if he sleeps, he will get better."

13 Jesus was talking about death, while his disciples thought he was talking about taking a nap.

13 Jesus had been speaking of his death, but his disciples thought he meant natural sleep.

14 Then Jesus became explicit: "Lazarus died.

14 So then he told them plainly, "Lazarus is dead,

15 And I am glad for your sakes that I wasn't there. You're about to be given new grounds for believing. Now let's go to him."

15 and for your sake I am glad I was not there, so that you may believe. But let us go to him."

16 That's when Thomas, the one called the Twin, said to his companions, "Come along. We might as well die with him."

16 Then Thomas (called Didymus) said to the rest of the disciples, "Let us also go, that we may die with him."

17 When Jesus finally got there, he found Lazarus already four days dead.

17 On his arrival, Jesus found that Lazarus had already been in the tomb for four days.

18 Bethany was near Jerusalem, only a couple of miles away,

18 Bethany was less than two miles from Jerusalem,

19 and many of the Jews were visiting Martha and Mary, sympathizing with them over their brother.

19 and many Jews had come to Martha and Mary to comfort them in the loss of their brother.

20 Martha heard Jesus was coming and went out to meet him. Mary remained in the house.

20 When Martha heard that Jesus was coming, she went out to meet him, but Mary stayed at home.

21 Martha said, "Master, if you'd been here, my brother wouldn't have died.

21 Lord, Martha said to Jesus, "if you had been here, my brother would not have died.

22 Even now, I know that whatever you ask God he will give you."

22 But I know that even now God will give you whatever you ask."

23 Jesus said, "Your brother will be raised up."

23 Jesus said to her, "Your brother will rise again."

24 Martha replied, "I know that he will be raised up in the resurrection at the end of time."

24 Martha answered, "I know he will rise again in the resurrection at the last day."

25 "You don't have to wait for the End. I am, right now, Resurrection and Life. The one who believes in me, even though he or she dies, will live.

25 Jesus said to her, "I am the resurrection and the life. He who believes in me will live, even though he dies;

26 And everyone who lives believing in me does not ultimately die at all. Do you believe this?"

26 and whoever lives and believes in me will never die. Do you believe this?"

27 "Yes, Master. All along I have believed that you are the Messiah, the Son of God who comes into the world."

27 Yes, Lord, she told him, "I believe that you are the Christ, the Son of God, who was to come into the world."

28 After saying this, she went to her sister Mary and whispered in her ear, "The Teacher is here and is asking for you."

28 And after she had said this, she went back and called her sister Mary aside. "The Teacher is here," she said, "and is asking for you."

29 The moment she heard that, she jumped up and ran out to him.

29 When Mary heard this, she got up quickly and went to him.

30 Jesus had not yet entered the town but was still at the place where Martha had met him.

30 Now Jesus had not yet entered the village, but was still at the place where Martha had met him.

31 When her sympathizing Jewish friends saw Mary run off, they followed her, thinking she was on her way to the tomb to weep there.

31 When the Jews who had been with Mary in the house, comforting her, noticed how quickly she got up and went out, they followed her, supposing she was going to the tomb to mourn there.

32 Mary came to where Jesus was waiting and fell at his feet, saying, "Master, if only you had been here, my brother would not have died."

32 When Mary reached the place where Jesus was and saw him, she fell at his feet and said, "Lord, if you had been here, my brother would not have died."

33 When Jesus saw her sobbing and the Jews with her sobbing, a deep anger welled up within him.

33 When Jesus saw her weeping, and the Jews who had come along with her also weeping, he was deeply moved in spirit and troubled.

34 He said, "Where did you put him?" "Master, come and see," they said.

34 Where have you laid him? he asked. "Come and see, Lord," they replied.

35 Now Jesus wept.

35 Jesus wept.

36 The Jews said, "Look how deeply he loved him."

36 Then the Jews said, "See how he loved him!"

37 Others among them said, "Well, if he loved him so much, why didn't he do something to keep him from dying? After all, he opened the eyes of a blind man."

37 But some of them said, "Could not he who opened the eyes of the blind man have kept this man from dying?"

38 Then Jesus, the anger again welling up within him, arrived at the tomb. It was a simple cave in the hillside with a slab of stone laid against it.

38 Jesus, once more deeply moved, came to the tomb. It was a cave with a stone laid across the entrance.

39 Jesus said, "Remove the stone." The sister of the dead man, Martha, said, "Master, by this time there's a stench. He's been dead four days!"

39 Take away the stone, he said. "But, Lord," said Martha, the sister of the dead man, "by this time there is a bad odor, for he has been there four days."

40 Jesus looked her in the eye. "Didn't I tell you that if you believed, you would see the glory of God?"

40 Then Jesus said, "Did I not tell you that if you believed, you would see the glory of God?"

41 Then, to the others, "Go ahead, take away the stone." They removed the stone. Jesus raised his eyes to heaven and prayed, "Father, I'm grateful that you have listened to me."

41 So they took away the stone. Then Jesus looked up and said, "Father, I thank you that you have heard me.

42 I know you always do listen, but on account of this crowd standing here I've spoken so that they might believe that you sent me."

42 I knew that you always hear me, but I said this for the benefit of the people standing here, that they may believe that you sent me."

43 Then he shouted, "Lazarus, come out!"

43 When he had said this, Jesus called in a loud voice, "Lazarus, come out!"

44 And he came out, a cadaver, wrapped from head to toe, and with a kerchief over his face. Jesus told them, "Unwrap him and let him loose."

44 The dead man came out, his hands and feet wrapped with strips of linen, and a cloth around his face. Jesus said to them, "Take off the grave clothes and let him go."

45 That was a turnaround for many of the Jews who were with Mary. They saw what Jesus did, and believed in him.

45 Therefore many of the Jews who had come to visit Mary, and had seen what Jesus did, put their faith in him.

46 But some went back to the Pharisees and told on Jesus.

46 But some of them went to the Pharisees and told them what Jesus had done.

47 The high priests and Pharisees called a meeting of the Jewish ruling body. "What do we do now?" they asked. "This man keeps on doing things, creating God-signs.

47 Then the chief priests and the Pharisees called a meeting of the Sanhedrin. "What are we accomplishing?" they asked. "Here is this man performing many miraculous signs.

48 If we let him go on, pretty soon everyone will be believing in him and the Romans will come and remove what little power and privilege we still have."

48 If we let him go on like this, everyone will believe in him, and then the Romans will come and take away both our place and our nation."

49 Then one of them--it was Caiaphas, the designated Chief Priest that year--spoke up, "Don't you know anything?

49 Then one of them, named Caiaphas, who was high priest that year, spoke up, "You know nothing at all!

50 Can't you see that it's to our advantage that one man dies for the people rather than the whole nation be destroyed?"

50 You do not realize that it is better for you that one man die for the people than that the whole nation perish."

51 He didn't say this of his own accord, but as Chief Priest that year he unwittingly prophesied that Jesus was about to die sacrificially for the nation,

51 He did not say this on his own, but as high priest that year he prophesied that Jesus would die for the Jewish nation,

52 and not only for the nation but so that all God's exile-scattered children might be gathered together into one people.

52 and not only for that nation but also for the scattered children of God, to bring them together and make them one.

53 From that day on, they plotted to kill him.

53 So from that day on they plotted to take his life.

54 So Jesus no longer went out in public among the Jews. He withdrew into the country bordering the desert to a town called Ephraim and secluded himself there with his disciples.

54 Therefore Jesus no longer moved about publicly among the Jews. Instead he withdrew to a region near the desert, to a village called Ephraim, where he stayed with his disciples.

55 The Jewish Passover was coming up. Crowds of people were making their way from the country up to Jerusalem to get themselves ready for the Feast.

55 When it was almost time for the Jewish Passover, many went up from the country to Jerusalem for their ceremonial cleansing before the Passover.

56 They were curious about Jesus. There was a lot of talk of him among those standing around in the Temple: "What do you think? Do you think he'll show up at the Feast or not?"

56 They kept looking for Jesus, and as they stood in the temple area they asked one another, "What do you think? Isn't he coming to the Feast at all?"

57 Meanwhile, the high priests and Pharisees gave out the word that anyone getting wind of him should inform them. They were all set to arrest him.

57 But the chief priests and Pharisees had given orders that if anyone found out where Jesus was, he should report it so that they might arrest him.

John 12

MSG

NIV

- 1 Six days before Passover, Jesus entered Bethany where Lazarus, so recently raised from the dead, was living.
- 1 Six days before the Passover, Jesus arrived at Bethany, where Lazarus lived, whom Jesus had raised from the dead.
- 2 Lazarus and his sisters invited Jesus to dinner at their home. Martha served. Lazarus was one of those sitting at the table with them.
- 2 Here a dinner was given in Jesus' honor. Martha served, while Lazarus was among those reclining at the table with him.
- 3 Mary came in with a jar of very expensive aromatic oils, anointed and massaged Jesus' feet, and then wiped them with her hair. The fragrance of the oils filled the house.
- 3 Then Mary took about a pint of pure nard, an expensive perfume; she poured it on Jesus' feet and wiped his feet with her hair. And the house was filled with the fragrance of the perfume.
- 4 Judas Iscariot, one of his disciples, even then getting ready to betray him, said,
- 4 But one of his disciples, Judas Iscariot, who was later to betray him, objected,
- 5 "Why wasn't this oil sold and the money given to the poor? It would have easily brought three hundred silver pieces."
- 5 Why wasn't this perfume sold and the money given to the poor? It was worth a year's wages.
- 6 He said this not because he cared two cents about the poor but because he was a thief. He was in charge of their common funds, but also embezzled them.
- 6 He did not say this because he cared about the poor but because he was a thief; as keeper of the money bag, he used to help himself to what was put into it.

- 7 Jesus said, "Let her alone. She's anticipating and honoring the day of my burial.
- 7 Leave her alone, Jesus replied. "It was intended that she should save this perfume for the day of my burial.
- 8 You always have the poor with you. You don't always have me."
- 8 You will always have the poor among you, but you will not always have me."
- 9 Word got out among the Jews that he was back in town. The people came to take a look, not only at Jesus but also at Lazarus, who had been raised from the dead.
- 9 Meanwhile a large crowd of Jews found out that Jesus was there and came, not only because of him but also to see Lazarus, whom he had raised from the dead.
- 10 So the high priests plotted to kill Lazarus
- 10 So the chief priests made plans to kill Lazarus as well,
- 11 because so many of the Jews were going over and believing in Jesus on account of him.
- 11 for on account of him many of the Jews were going over to Jesus and putting their faith in him.
- 12 The next day the huge crowd that had arrived for the Feast heard that Jesus was entering Jerusalem.
- 12 The next day the great crowd that had come for the Feast heard that Jesus was on his way to Jerusalem.
- 13 They broke off palm branches and went out to meet him. And they cheered: Hosanna! Blessed is he who comes in God's name! Yes! The King of Israel!
- 13 They took palm branches and went out to meet him, shouting, "Hosanna! " "Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord!" "Blessed is the King of Israel!"
- 14 Jesus got a young donkey and rode it, just as the Scripture has it:
- 14 Jesus found a young donkey and sat upon it, as it is written,
- 15 No fear, Daughter Zion: See how your king comes, riding a donkey's colt.
- 15 Do not be afraid, O Daughter of Zion; see, your king is coming, seated on a donkey's colt.

- 16 The disciples didn't notice the fulfillment of many Scriptures at the time, but after Jesus was glorified, they remembered that what was written about him matched what was done to him.
- 16 At first his disciples did not understand all this. Only after Jesus was glorified did they realize that these things had been written about him and that they had done these things to him.
- 17 The crowd that had been with him when he called Lazarus from the tomb, raising him from the dead, was there giving eyewitness accounts.
- 17 Now the crowd that was with him when he called Lazarus from the tomb and raised him from the dead continued to spread the word.
- 18 It was because they had spread the word of this latest God-sign that the crowd swelled to a welcoming parade.
- 18 Many people, because they had heard that he had given this miraculous sign, went out to meet him.
- 19 The Pharisees took one look and threw up their hands: "It's out of control. The world's in a stampede after him."
- 19 So the Pharisees said to one another, "See, this is getting us nowhere. Look how the whole world has gone after him!"
- 20 There were some Greeks in town who had come up to worship at the Feast.
- 20 Now there were some Greeks among those who went up to worship at the Feast.
- 21 They approached Philip, who was from Bethsaida in Galilee: "Sir, we want to see Jesus. Can you help us?"
- 21 They came to Philip, who was from Bethsaida in Galilee, with a request. "Sir," they said, "we would like to see Jesus."
- 22 Philip went and told Andrew. Andrew and Philip together told Jesus.
- 22 Philip went to tell Andrew; Andrew and Philip in turn told Jesus.
- 23 Jesus answered, "Time's up. The time has come for the Son of Man to be glorified.
- 23 Jesus replied, "The hour has come for the Son of Man to be glorified.
- 24 "Listen carefully: Unless a grain of wheat is buried in the ground, dead to the world, it is never any more than a grain of wheat. But if it is buried, it sprouts and reproduces itself many times over.
- 24 I tell you the truth, unless a kernel of wheat falls to the ground and dies, it remains only a single seed. But if it dies, it produces many seeds.

25 In the same way, anyone who holds on to life just as it is destroys that life. But if you let it go, reckless in your love, you'll have it forever, real and eternal.

25 The man who loves his life will lose it, while the man who hates his life in this world will keep it for eternal life.

26 "If any of you wants to serve me, then follow me. Then you'll be where I am, ready to serve at a moment's notice. The Father will honor and reward anyone who serves me.

26 Whoever serves me must follow me; and where I am, my servant also will be. My Father will honor the one who serves me.

27 "Right now I am storm-tossed. And what am I going to say? 'Father, get me out of this'? No, this is why I came in the first place.

27 Now my heart is troubled, and what shall I say? 'Father, save me from this hour'? No, it was for this very reason I came to this hour.

28 I'll say, 'Father, put your glory on display.'" A voice came out of the sky: "I have glorified it, and I'll glorify it again."

28 Father, glorify your name!" Then a voice came from heaven, "I have glorified it, and will glorify it again."

29 The listening crowd said, "Thunder!" Others said, "An angel spoke to him!"

29 The crowd that was there and heard it said it had thundered; others said an angel had spoken to him.

30 Jesus said, "The voice didn't come for me but for you.

30 Jesus said, "This voice was for your benefit, not mine.

31 At this moment the world is in crisis. Now Satan, the ruler of this world, will be thrown out.

31 Now is the time for judgment on this world; now the prince of this world will be driven out.

32 And I, as I am lifted up from the earth, will attract everyone to me and gather them around me."

32 But I, when I am lifted up from the earth, will draw all men to myself."

33 He put it this way to show how he was going to be put to death.

33 He said this to show the kind of death he was going to die.

34 Voices from the crowd answered, "We heard from God's Law that the Messiah lasts forever. How can it be necessary, as you put it, that the Son of Man 'be lifted up'? Who is this 'Son of Man'?"

- 34 The crowd spoke up, "We have heard from the Law that the Christ will remain forever, so how can you say, 'The Son of Man must be lifted up'? Who is this 'Son of Man'?"
- 35 Jesus said, "For a brief time still, the light is among you. Walk by the light you have so darkness doesn't destroy you. If you walk in darkness, you don't know where you're going.
- 35 Then Jesus told them, "You are going to have the light just a little while longer. Walk while you have the light, before darkness overtakes you. The man who walks in the dark does not know where he is going.
- 36 As you have the light, believe in the light. Then the light will be within you, and shining through your lives. You'll be children of light." Jesus said all this, and then went into hiding.
- 36 Put your trust in the light while you have it, so that you may become sons of light." When he had finished speaking, Jesus left and hid himself from them.
- 37 All these God-signs he had given them and they still didn't get it, still wouldn't trust him.
- 37 Even after Jesus had done all these miraculous signs in their presence, they still would not believe in him.
- 38 This proved that the prophet Isaiah was right: God, who believed what we preached? Who recognized God's arm, outstretched and ready to act?
- 38 This was to fulfill the word of Isaiah the prophet: "Lord, who has believed our message and to whom has the arm of the Lord been revealed?"
- 39 First they wouldn't believe, then they couldn't--again, just as Isaiah said:
- 39 For this reason they could not believe, because, as Isaiah says elsewhere:
- 40 Their eyes are blinded, their hearts are hardened, So that they wouldn't see with their eyes and perceive with their hearts, And turn to me, God, so I could heal them.
- 40 He has blinded their eyes and deadened their hearts, so they can neither see with their eyes, nor understand with their hearts, nor turn--and I would heal them.
- 41 Isaiah said these things after he got a glimpse of God's cascading brightness that would pour through the Messiah.
- 41 Isaiah said this because he saw Jesus' glory and spoke about him.

42 On the other hand, a considerable number from the ranks of the leaders did believe. But because of the Pharisees, they didn't come out in the open with it. They were afraid of getting kicked out of the meeting place.

42 Yet at the same time many even among the leaders believed in him. But because of the Pharisees they would not confess their faith for fear they would be put out of the synagogue;

43 When push came to shove they cared more for human approval than for God's glory.

43 for they loved praise from men more than praise from God.

44 Jesus summed it all up when he cried out, "Whoever believes in me, believes not just in me but in the One who sent me.

44 Then Jesus cried out, "When a man believes in me, he does not believe in me only, but in the one who sent me.

45 Whoever looks at me is looking, in fact, at the One who sent me.

45 When he looks at me, he sees the one who sent me.

46 I am Light that has come into the world so that all who believe in me won't have to stay any longer in the dark.

46 I have come into the world as a light, so that no one who believes in me should stay in darkness.

47 "If anyone hears what I am saying and doesn't take it seriously, I don't reject him. I didn't come to reject the world;

47 As for the person who hears my words but does not keep them, I do not judge him. For I did not come to judge the world, but to save it.

48 I came to save the world. But you need to know that whoever puts me off, refusing to take in what I'm saying, is willfully choosing rejection. The Word, the Word-made-flesh that I have spoken and that I am, that Word and no other is the last word.

48 There is a judge for the one who rejects me and does not accept my words; that very word which I spoke will condemn him at the last day.

49 I'm not making any of this up on my own. The Father who sent me gave me orders, told me what to say and how to say it.

49 For I did not speak of my own accord, but the Father who sent me commanded me what to say and how to say it.

50 And I know exactly what his command produces: real and eternal life. That's all I have to say. What the Father told me, I tell you."

50 I know that his command leads to eternal life. So whatever I say is just what the Father has told me to say."

John 13

MSG

NIV

- 1 Just before the Passover Feast, Jesus knew that the time had come to leave this world to go to the Father. Having loved his dear companions, he continued to love them right to the end.
- 1 It was just before the Passover Feast. Jesus knew that the time had come for him to leave this world and go to the Father. Having loved his own who were in the world, he now showed them the full extent of his love.
- 2 It was suppertime. The Devil by now had Judas, son of Simon the Iscariot, firmly in his grip, all set for the betrayal.
- 2 The evening meal was being served, and the devil had already prompted Judas Iscariot, son of Simon, to betray Jesus.
- 3 Jesus knew that the Father had put him in complete charge of everything, that he came from God and was on his way back to God.
- 3 Jesus knew that the Father had put all things under his power, and that he had come from God and was returning to God;
- 4 So he got up from the supper table, set aside his robe, and put on an apron.
- 4 so he got up from the meal, took off his outer clothing, and wrapped a towel around his waist.
- 5 Then he poured water into a basin and began to wash the feet of the disciples, drying them with his apron.
- 5 After that, he poured water into a basin and began to wash his disciples' feet, drying them with the towel that was wrapped around him.
- 6 When he got to Simon Peter, Peter said, "Master, you wash my feet?"
- 6 He came to Simon Peter, who said to him, "Lord, are you going to wash my feet?"
- 7 Jesus answered, "You don't understand now what I'm doing, but it will be clear enough to you later."
- 7 Jesus replied, "You do not realize now what I am doing, but later you will understand."

- 8 Peter persisted, "You're not going to wash my feet--ever!" Jesus said, "If I don't wash you, you can't be part of what I'm doing."
- 8 No, said Peter, "you shall never wash my feet." Jesus answered, "Unless I wash you, you have no part with me."
- 9 "Master!" said Peter. "Not only my feet, then. Wash my hands! Wash my head!"
- 9 Then, Lord, Simon Peter replied, "not just my feet but my hands and my head as well!"
- 10 Jesus said, "If you've had a bath in the morning, you only need your feet washed now and you're clean from head to toe. My concern, you understand, is holiness, not hygiene. So now you're clean. But not every one of you."
- 10 Jesus answered, "A person who has had a bath needs only to wash his feet; his whole body is clean. And you are clean, though not every one of you."
- 11 (He knew who was betraying him. That's why he said, "Not every one of you.")
- 11 For he knew who was going to betray him, and that was why he said not every one was clean.
- 12 After he had finished washing their feet, he took his robe, put it back on, and went back to his place at the table. Then he said, "Do you understand what I have done to you?"
- 12 When he had finished washing their feet, he put on his clothes and returned to his place. "Do you understand what I have done for you?" he asked them.
- 13 You address me as 'Teacher' and 'Master,' and rightly so. That is what I am.
- 13 You call me 'Teacher' and 'Lord,' and rightly so, for that is what I am.
- 14 So if I, the Master and Teacher, washed your feet, you must now wash each other's feet.
- 14 Now that I, your Lord and Teacher, have washed your feet, you also should wash one another's feet.
- 15 I've laid down a pattern for you. What I've done, you do.
- 15 I have set you an example that you should do as I have done for you.
- 16 I'm only pointing out the obvious. A servant is not ranked above his master; an employee doesn't give orders to the employer.

16 I tell you the truth, no servant is greater than his master, nor is a messenger greater than the one who sent him.

17 If you understand what I'm telling you, act like it--and live a blessed life.

17 Now that you know these things, you will be blessed if you do them.

18 "I'm not including all of you in this. I know precisely whom I've selected, so as not to interfere with the fulfillment of this Scripture: The one who ate bread at my table Turned on his heel against me.

18 I am not referring to all of you; I know those I have chosen. But this is to fulfill the scripture: 'He who shares my bread has lifted up his heel against me.'

19 "I'm telling you all this ahead of time so that when it happens you will believe that I am who I say I am.

19 I am telling you now before it happens, so that when it does happen you will believe that I am He.

20 Make sure you get this right: Receiving someone I send is the same as receiving me, just as receiving me is the same as receiving the One who sent me."

20 I tell you the truth, whoever accepts anyone I send accepts me; and whoever accepts me accepts the one who sent me."

21 After he said these things, Jesus became visibly upset, and then he told them why. "One of you is going to betray me."

21 After he had said this, Jesus was troubled in spirit and testified, "I tell you the truth, one of you is going to betray me."

22 The disciples looked around at one another, wondering who on earth he was talking about.

22 His disciples stared at one another, at a loss to know which of them he meant.

23 One of the disciples, the one Jesus loved dearly, was reclining against him, his head on his shoulder.

23 One of them, the disciple whom Jesus loved, was reclining next to him.

24 Peter motioned to him to ask who Jesus might be talking about.

24 Simon Peter motioned to this disciple and said, "Ask him which one he means."

25 So, being the closest, he said, "Master, who?"

25 Leaning back against Jesus, he asked him, "Lord, who is it?"

- 26 Jesus said, "The one to whom I give this crust of bread after I've dipped it." Then he dipped the crust and gave it to Judas, son of Simon the Iscariot.
- 26 Jesus answered, "It is the one to whom I will give this piece of bread when I have dipped it in the dish." Then, dipping the piece of bread, he gave it to Judas Iscariot, son of Simon.
- 27 As soon as the bread was in his hand, Satan entered him. "What you must do," said Jesus, "do. Do it and get it over with."
- 27 As soon as Judas took the bread, Satan entered into him. "What you are about to do, do quickly," Jesus told him,
- 28 No one around the supper table knew why he said this to him.
- 28 but no one at the meal understood why Jesus said this to him.
- 29 Some thought that since Judas was their treasurer, Jesus was telling him to buy what they needed for the Feast, or that he should give something to the poor.
- 29 Since Judas had charge of the money, some thought Jesus was telling him to buy what was needed for the Feast, or to give something to the poor.
- 30 Judas, with the piece of bread, left. It was night.
- 30 As soon as Judas had taken the bread, he went out. And it was night.
- 31 When he had left, Jesus said, "Now the Son of Man is seen for who he is, and God seen for who he is in him. The moment God is seen in him,
- 31 When he was gone, Jesus said, "Now is the Son of Man glorified and God is glorified in him.
- 32 God's glory will be on display. In glorifying him, he himself is glorified-glory all around!
- 32 If God is glorified in him, God will glorify the Son in himself, and will glorify him at once.
- 33 "Children, I am with you for only a short time longer. You are going to look high and low for me. But just as I told the Jews, I'm telling you: 'Where I go, you are not able to come.'
- 33 My children, I will be with you only a little longer. You will look for me, and just as I told the Jews, so I tell you now: Where I am going, you cannot come.
- 34 "Let me give you a new command: Love one another. In the same way I loved you, you love one another.

- 34 A new command I give you: Love one another. As I have loved you, so you must love one another.
- 35 This is how everyone will recognize that you are my disciples--when they see the love you have for each other."
- 35 By this all men will know that you are my disciples, if you love one another."
- 36 Simon Peter asked, "Master, just where are you going?" Jesus answered, "You can't now follow me where I'm going. You will follow later."
- 36 Simon Peter asked him, "Lord, where are you going?" Jesus replied, "Where I am going, you cannot follow now, but you will follow later."
- 37 "Master," said Peter, "why can't I follow now? I'll lay down my life for you!"
- 37 Peter asked, "Lord, why can't I follow you now? I will lay down my life for you."
- 38 "Really? You'll lay down your life for me? The truth is that before the rooster crows, you'll deny me three times."
- 38 Then Jesus answered, "Will you really lay down your life for me? I tell you the truth, before the rooster crows, you will disown me three times!"

John 14

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Don't let this throw you. You trust God, don't you? Trust me.
- 1 Do not let your hearts be troubled. Trust in God; trust also in me.
- 2 There is plenty of room for you in my Father's home. If that weren't so, would I have told you that I'm on my way to get a room ready for you?
- 2 In my Father's house are many rooms; if it were not so, I would have told you. I am going there to prepare a place for you.
- 3 And if I'm on my way to get your room ready, I'll come back and get you so you can live where I live.
- 3 And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come back and take you to be with me that you also may be where I am.
- 4 And you already know the road I'm taking."
- 4 You know the way to the place where I am going."

- 5 Thomas said, "Master, we have no idea where you're going. How do you expect us to know the road?"
- 5 Thomas said to him, "Lord, we don't know where you are going, so how can we know the way?"
- 6 Jesus said, "I am the Road, also the Truth, also the Life. No one gets to the Father apart from me.
- 6 Jesus answered, "I am the way and the truth and the life. No one comes to the Father except through me.
- 7 If you really knew me, you would know my Father as well. From now on, you do know him. You've even seen him!"
- 7 If you really knew me, you would know my Father as well. From now on, you do know him and have seen him."
- 8 Philip said, "Master, show us the Father; then we'll be content."
- 8 Philip said, "Lord, show us the Father and that will be enough for us."
- 9 "You've been with me all this time, Philip, and you still don't understand? To see me is to see the Father. So how can you ask, 'Where is the Father?'
- 9 Jesus answered: "Don't you know me, Philip, even after I have been among you such a long time? Anyone who has seen me has seen the Father. How can you say, 'Show us the Father'?"
- 10 Don't you believe that I am in the Father and the Father is in me? The words that I speak to you aren't mere words. I don't just make them up on my own. The Father who resides in me crafts each word into a divine act.
- 10 Don't you believe that I am in the Father, and that the Father is in me? The words I say to you are not just my own. Rather, it is the Father, living in me, who is doing his work.
- 11 "Believe me: I am in my Father and my Father is in me. If you can't believe that, believe what you see--these works.
- 11 Believe me when I say that I am in the Father and the Father is in me; or at least believe on the evidence of the miracles themselves.
- 12 The person who trusts me will not only do what I'm doing but even greater things, because I, on my way to the Father, am giving you the same work to do that I've been doing. You can count on it.
- 12 I tell you the truth, anyone who has faith in me will do what I have been doing. He will do even greater things than these, because I am going to

the Father.

13 From now on, whatever you request along the lines of who I am and what I am doing, I'll do it. That's how the Father will be seen for who he is in the Son. I mean it.

13 And I will do whatever you ask in my name, so that the Son may bring glory to the Father.

14 Whatever you request in this way, I'll do.

14 You may ask me for anything in my name, and I will do it.

15 "If you love me, show it by doing what I've told you.

15 If you love me, you will obey what I command.

16 I will talk to the Father, and he'll provide you another Friend so that you will always have someone with you.

16 And I will ask the Father, and he will give you another Counselor to be with you forever--

17 This Friend is the Spirit of Truth. The godless world can't take him in because it doesn't have eyes to see him, doesn't know what to look for. But you know him already because he has been staying with you, and will even be in you!

17 the Spirit of truth. The world cannot accept him, because it neither sees him nor knows him. But you know him, for he lives with you and will be in you.

18 "I will not leave you orphaned. I'm coming back.

18 I will not leave you as orphans; I will come to you.

19 In just a little while the world will no longer see me, but you're going to see me because I am alive and you're about to come alive.

19 Before long, the world will not see me anymore, but you will see me. Because I live, you also will live.

20 At that moment you will know absolutely that I'm in my Father, and you're in me, and I'm in you.

20 On that day you will realize that I am in my Father, and you are in me, and I am in you.

21 "The person who knows my commandments and keeps them, that's who loves me. And the person who loves me will be loved by my Father, and I will love him and make myself plain to him."

21 Whoever has my commands and obeys them, he is the one who loves me. He who loves me will be loved by my Father, and I too will love

- him and show myself to him."
- 22 Judas (not Iscariot) said, "Master, why is it that you are about to make yourself plain to us but not to the world?"
- 22 Then Judas (not Judas Iscariot) said, "But, Lord, why do you intend to show yourself to us and not to the world?"
- 23 "Because a loveless world," said Jesus, "is a sightless world. If anyone loves me, he will carefully keep my word and my Father will love him--we'll move right into the neighborhood!
- 23 Jesus replied, "If anyone loves me, he will obey my teaching. My Father will love him, and we will come to him and make our home with him.
- 24 Not loving me means not keeping my words. The message you are hearing isn't mine. It's the message of the Father who sent me.
- 24 He who does not love me will not obey my teaching. These words you hear are not my own; they belong to the Father who sent me.
- 25 "I'm telling you these things while I'm still living with you.
- 25 All this I have spoken while still with you.
- 26 The Friend, the Holy Spirit whom the Father will send at my request, will make everything plain to you. He will remind you of all the things I have told you.
- 26 But the Counselor, the Holy Spirit, whom the Father will send in my name, will teach you all things and will remind you of everything I have said to you.
- 27 I'm leaving you well and whole. That's my parting gift to you. Peace. I don't leave you the way you're used to being left--feeling abandoned, bereft. So don't be upset. Don't be distraught.
- 27 Peace I leave with you; my peace I give you. I do not give to you as the world gives. Do not let your hearts be troubled and do not be afraid.
- 28 "You've heard me tell you, 'I'm going away, and I'm coming back.' If you loved me, you would be glad that I'm on my way to the Father because the Father is the goal and purpose of my life.
- 28 You heard me say, 'I am going away and I am coming back to you.' If you loved me, you would be glad that I am going to the Father, for the Father is greater than I.
- 29 "I've told you this ahead of time, before it happens, so that when it does happen, the confirmation will deepen your belief in me.

- 29 I have told you now before it happens, so that when it does happen you will believe.
- 30 I'll not be talking with you much more like this because the chief of this godless world is about to attack. But don't worry--he has nothing on me, no claim on me.
- 30 I will not speak with you much longer, for the prince of this world is coming. He has no hold on me,
- 31 But so the world might know how thoroughly I love the Father, I am carrying out my Father's instructions right down to the last detail. "Get up. Let's go. It's time to leave here.
- 31 but the world must learn that I love the Father and that I do exactly what my Father has commanded me. "Come now; let us leave.

John 15

MSG

NIV

- 1 "I am the Real Vine and my Father is the Farmer.
- 1 I am the true vine, and my Father is the gardener.
- 2 He cuts off every branch of me that doesn't bear grapes. And every branch that is grape-bearing he prunes back so it will bear even more.
- 2 He cuts off every branch in me that bears no fruit, while every branch that does bear fruit he prunes so that it will be even more fruitful.
- 3 You are already pruned back by the message I have spoken.
- 3 You are already clean because of the word I have spoken to you.
- 4 "Live in me. Make your home in me just as I do in you. In the same way that a branch can't bear grapes by itself but only by being joined to the vine, you can't bear fruit unless you are joined with me.
- 4 Remain in me, and I will remain in you. No branch can bear fruit by itself; it must remain in the vine. Neither can you bear fruit unless you remain in me.
- 5 "I am the Vine, you are the branches. When you're joined with me and I with you, the relation intimate and organic, the harvest is sure to be abundant. Separated, you can't produce a thing.
- 5 I am the vine; you are the branches. If a man remains in me and I in him, he will bear much fruit; apart from me you can do nothing.

- 6 Anyone who separates from me is deadwood, gathered up and thrown on the bonfire.
- 6 If anyone does not remain in me, he is like a branch that is thrown away and withers; such branches are picked up, thrown into the fire and burned.
- 7 But if you make yourselves at home with me and my words are at home in you, you can be sure that whatever you ask will be listened to and acted upon.
- 7 If you remain in me and my words remain in you, ask whatever you wish, and it will be given you.
- 8 This is how my Father shows who he is--when you produce grapes, when you mature as my disciples.
- 8 This is to my Father's glory, that you bear much fruit, showing yourselves to be my disciples.
- 9 "I've loved you the way my Father has loved me. Make yourselves at home in my love.
- 9 As the Father has loved me, so have I loved you. Now remain in my love.
- 10 If you keep my commands, you'll remain intimately at home in my love. That's what I've done--kept my Father's commands and made myself at home in his love.
- 10 If you obey my commands, you will remain in my love, just as I have obeyed my Father's commands and remain in his love.
- 11 "I've told you these things for a purpose: that my joy might be your joy, and your joy wholly mature.
- 11 I have told you this so that my joy may be in you and that your joy may be complete.
- 12 This is my command: Love one another the way I loved you.
- 12 My command is this: Love each other as I have loved you.
- 13 This is the very best way to love. Put your life on the line for your friends.
- 13 Greater love has no one than this, that he lay down his life for his friends.
- 14 You are my friends when you do the things I command you.
- 14 You are my friends if you do what I command.
- 15 I'm no longer calling you servants because servants don't understand what their master is thinking and planning. No, I've named you friends

- because I've let you in on everything I've heard from the Father.
- 15 I no longer call you servants, because a servant does not know his master's business. Instead, I have called you friends, for everything that I learned from my Father I have made known to you.
- 16 "You didn't choose me, remember; I chose you, and put you in the world to bear fruit, fruit that won't spoil. As fruit bearers, whatever you ask the Father in relation to me, he gives you.
- 16 You did not choose me, but I chose you and appointed you to go and bear fruit--fruit that will last. Then the Father will give you whatever you ask in my name.
- 17 "But remember the root command: Love one another.
- 17 This is my command: Love each other.
- 18 "If you find the godless world is hating you, remember it got its start hating me.
- 18 If the world hates you, keep in mind that it hated me first.
- 19 If you lived on the world's terms, the world would love you as one of its own. But since I picked you to live on God's terms and no longer on the world's terms, the world is going to hate you.
- 19 If you belonged to the world, it would love you as its own. As it is, you do not belong to the world, but I have chosen you out of the world. That is why the world hates you.
- 20 "When that happens, remember this: Servants don't get better treatment than their masters. If they beat on me, they will certainly beat on you. If they did what I told them, they will do what you tell them.
- 20 Remember the words I spoke to you: 'No servant is greater than his master.' If they persecuted me, they will persecute you also. If they obeyed my teaching, they will obey yours also.
- 21 "They are going to do all these things to you because of the way they treated me, because they don't know the One who sent me.
- 21 They will treat you this way because of my name, for they do not know the One who sent me.
- 22 If I hadn't come and told them all this in plain language, it wouldn't be so bad. As it is, they have no excuse.
- 22 If I had not come and spoken to them, they would not be guilty of sin. Now, however, they have no excuse for their sin.
- 23 Hate me, hate my Father--it's all the same.

- 23 He who hates me hates my Father as well.
- 24 If I hadn't done what I have done among them, works no one has ever done, they wouldn't be to blame. But they saw the God-signs and hated anyway, both me and my Father.
- 24 If I had not done among them what no one else did, they would not be guilty of sin. But now they have seen these miracles, and yet they have hated both me and my Father.
- 25 Interesting--they have verified the truth of their own Scriptures where it is written, 'They hated me for no good reason.'
- 25 But this is to fulfill what is written in their Law: 'They hated me without reason.'
- 26 "When the Friend I plan to send you from the Father comes--the Spirit of Truth issuing from the Father--he will confirm everything about me.
- 26 When the Counselor comes, whom I will send to you from the Father, the Spirit of truth who goes out from the Father, he will testify about me.
- 27 You, too, from your side must give your confirming evidence, since you are in this with me from the start.
- 27 And you also must testify, for you have been with me from the beginning.

John 16

MSG

NIV

- 1 "I've told you these things to prepare you for rough times ahead.
- 1 All this I have told you so that you will not go astray.
- 2 They are going to throw you out of the meeting places. There will even come a time when anyone who kills you will think he's doing God a favor.
- 2 They will put you out of the synagogue; in fact, a time is coming when anyone who kills you will think he is offering a service to God.
- 3 They will do these things because they never really understood the Father.
- 3 They will do such things because they have not known the Father or me.
- 4 I've told you these things so that when the time comes and they start in on you, you'll be well-warned and ready for them. "I didn't tell you this

- earlier because I was with you every day.
- 4 I have told you this, so that when the time comes you will remember that I warned you. I did not tell you this at first because I was with you.
- 5 But now I am on my way to the One who sent me. Not one of you has asked, 'Where are you going?'
- 5 Now I am going to him who sent me, yet none of you asks me, 'Where are you going?'
- 6 Instead, the longer I've talked, the sadder you've become.
- 6 Because I have said these things, you are filled with grief.
- 7 So let me say it again, this truth: It's better for you that I leave. If I don't leave, the Friend won't come. But if I go, I'll send him to you.
- 7 But I tell you the truth: It is for your good that I am going away. Unless I go away, the Counselor will not come to you; but if I go, I will send him to you.
- 8 "When he comes, he'll expose the error of the godless world's view of sin, righteousness, and judgment:
- 8 When he comes, he will convict the world of guilt in regard to sin and righteousness and judgment:
- 9 He'll show them that their refusal to believe in me is their basic sin;
- 9 in regard to sin, because men do not believe in me;
- 10 that righteousness comes from above, where I am with the Father, out of their sight and control;
- 10 in regard to righteousness, because I am going to the Father, where you can see me no longer;
- 11 that judgment takes place as the ruler of this godless world is brought to trial and convicted.
- 11 and in regard to judgment, because the prince of this world now stands condemned.
- 12 "I still have many things to tell you, but you can't handle them now.
- 12 I have much more to say to you, more than you can now bear.
- 13 But when the Friend comes, the Spirit of the Truth, he will take you by the hand and guide you into all the truth there is. He won't draw attention to himself, but will make sense out of what is about to happen and, indeed, out of all that I have done and said.
- 13 But when he, the Spirit of truth, comes, he will guide you into all truth. He will not speak on his own; he will speak only what he hears, and he

- will tell you what is yet to come.
- 14 He will honor me; he will take from me and deliver it to you.
- 14 He will bring glory to me by taking from what is mine and making it known to you.
- 15 Everything the Father has is also mine. That is why I've said, 'He takes from me and delivers to you.'
- 15 All that belongs to the Father is mine. That is why I said the Spirit will take from what is mine and make it known to you.
- 16 "In a day or so you're not going to see me, but then in another day or so you will see me."
- 16 In a little while you will see me no more, and then after a little while you will see me.
- 17 That stirred up a hornet's nest of questions among the disciples: "What's he talking about: 'In a day or so you're not going to see me, but then in another day or so you will see me'? And, 'Because I'm on my way to the Father'?"
- 17 Some of his disciples said to one another, "What does he mean by saying, 'In a little while you will see me no more, and then after a little while you will see me,' and 'Because I am going to the Father'?"
- 18 What is this 'day or so'? We don't know what he's talking about."
- 18 They kept asking, "What does he mean by 'a little while'? We don't understand what he is saying."
- 19 Jesus knew they were dying to ask him what he meant, so he said, "Are you trying to figure out among yourselves what I meant when I said, 'In a day or so you're not going to see me, but then in another day or so you will see me'?"
- 19 Jesus saw that they wanted to ask him about this, so he said to them, "Are you asking one another what I meant when I said, 'In a little while you will see me no more, and then after a little while you will see me'?"
- 20 Then fix this firmly in your minds: You're going to be in deep mourning while the godless world throws a party. You'll be sad, very sad, but your sadness will develop into gladness.
- 20 I tell you the truth, you will weep and mourn while the world rejoices. You will grieve, but your grief will turn to joy.
- 21 "When a woman gives birth, she has a hard time, there's no getting around it. But when the baby is born, there is joy in the birth. This new

- life in the world wipes out memory of the pain.
- 21 A woman giving birth to a child has pain because her time has come; but when her baby is born she forgets the anguish because of her joy that a child is born into the world.
- 22 The sadness you have right now is similar to that pain, but the coming joy is also similar. When I see you again, you'll be full of joy, and it will be a joy no one can rob from you.
- 22 So with you: Now is your time of grief, but I will see you again and you will rejoice, and no one will take away your joy.
- 23 You'll no longer be so full of questions. "This is what I want you to do: Ask the Father for whatever is in keeping with the things I've revealed to you.
- 23 In that day you will no longer ask me anything. I tell you the truth, my Father will give you whatever you ask in my name.
- 24 Ask in my name, according to my will, and he'll most certainly give it to you. Your joy will be a river overflowing its banks!
- 24 Until now you have not asked for anything in my name. Ask and you will receive, and your joy will be complete.
- 25 "I've used figures of speech in telling you these things. Soon I'll drop the figures and tell you about the Father in plain language.
- 25 Though I have been speaking figuratively, a time is coming when I will no longer use this kind of language but will tell you plainly about my Father.
- 26 Then you can make your requests directly to him in relation to this life I've revealed to you. I won't continue making requests of the Father on your behalf.
- 26 In that day you will ask in my name. I am not saying that I will ask the Father on your behalf.
- 27 I won't need to. Because you've gone out on a limb, committed yourselves to love and trust in me, believing I came directly from the Father, the Father loves you directly.
- 27 No, the Father himself loves you because you have loved me and have believed that I came from God.
- 28 First, I left the Father and arrived in the world; now I leave the world and travel to the Father."

- 28 I came from the Father and entered the world; now I am leaving the world and going back to the Father."
- 29 His disciples said, "Finally! You're giving it to us straight, in plain talk--no more figures of speech.
- 29 Then Jesus' disciples said, "Now you are speaking clearly and without figures of speech.
- 30 Now we know that you know everything--it all comes together in you. You won't have to put up with our questions anymore. We're convinced you came from God."
- 30 Now we can see that you know all things and that you do not even need to have anyone ask you questions. This makes us believe that you came from God."
- 31 Jesus answered them, "Do you finally believe?
- 31 You believe at last! Jesus answered.
- 32 In fact, you're about to make a run for it--saving your own skins and abandoning me. But I'm not abandoned. The Father is with me.
- 32 But a time is coming, and has come, when you will be scattered, each to his own home. You will leave me all alone. Yet I am not alone, for my Father is with me.
- 33 I've told you all this so that trusting me, you will be unshakable and assured, deeply at peace. In this godless world you will continue to experience difficulties. But take heart! I've conquered the world."
- 33 I have told you these things, so that in me you may have peace. In this world you will have trouble. But take heart! I have overcome the world.

John 17

MSG

NIV

- 1 Jesus said these things. Then, raising his eyes in prayer, he said: Father, it's time. Display the bright splendor of your Son So the Son in turn may show your bright splendor.
- 1 After Jesus said this, he looked toward heaven and prayed: "Father, the time has come. Glorify your Son, that your Son may glorify you.
- 2 You put him in charge of everything human So he might give real and eternal life to all in his charge.

- 2 For you granted him authority over all people that he might give eternal life to all those you have given him.
- 3 And this is the real and eternal life: That they know you, The one and only true God, And Jesus Christ, whom you sent.
- 3 Now this is eternal life: that they may know you, the only true God, and Jesus Christ, whom you have sent.
- 4 I glorified you on earth By completing down to the last detail What you assigned me to do.
- 4 I have brought you glory on earth by completing the work you gave me to do.
- 5 And now, Father, glorify me with your very own splendor, The very splendor I had in your presence Before there was a world.
- 5 And now, Father, glorify me in your presence with the glory I had with you before the world began.
- 6 I spelled out your character in detail To the men and women you gave me. They were yours in the first place; Then you gave them to me, And they have now done what you said.
- 6 I have revealed you to those whom you gave me out of the world. They were yours; you gave them to me and they have obeyed your word.
- 7 They know now, beyond the shadow of a doubt, That everything you gave me is firsthand from you,
- 7 Now they know that everything you have given me comes from you.
- 8 For the message you gave me, I gave them; And they took it, and were convinced That I came from you. They believed that you sent me.
- 8 For I gave them the words you gave me and they accepted them. They knew with certainty that I came from you, and they believed that you sent me.
- 9 I pray for them. I'm not praying for the God-rejecting world But for those you gave me, For they are yours by right.
- 9 I pray for them. I am not praying for the world, but for those you have given me, for they are yours.
- 10 Everything mine is yours, and yours mine, And my life is on display in them.
- 10 All I have is yours, and all you have is mine. And glory has come to me through them.

- 11 For I'm no longer going to be visible in the world; They'll continue in the world While I return to you. Holy Father, guard them as they pursue this life That you conferred as a gift through me, So they can be one heart and mind
- 11 I will remain in the world no longer, but they are still in the world, and I am coming to you. Holy Father, protect them by the power of your name--the name you gave me--so that they may be one as we are one.
- 12 As we are one heart and mind. As long as I was with them, I guarded them In the pursuit of the life you gave through me; I even posted a night watch. And not one of them got away, Except for the rebel bent on destruction (the exception that proved the rule of Scripture).
- 12 While I was with them, I protected them and kept them safe by that name you gave me. None has been lost except the one doomed to destruction so that Scripture would be fulfilled.
- 13 Now I'm returning to you. I'm saying these things in the world's hearing So my people can experience My joy completed in them.
- 13 I am coming to you now, but I say these things while I am still in the world, so that they may have the full measure of my joy within them.
- 14 I gave them your word; The godless world hated them because of it, Because they didn't join the world's ways,
- 14 I have given them your word and the world has hated them, for they are not of the world any more than I am of the world.
- 15 Just as I didn't join the world's ways. I'm not asking that you take them out of the world But that you guard them from the Evil One.
- 15 My prayer is not that you take them out of the world but that you protect them from the evil one.
- 16 They are no more defined by the world Than I am defined by the world.
- 16 They are not of the world, even as I am not of it.
- 17 Make them holy--consecrated--with the truth; Your word is consecrating truth.
- 17 Sanctify them by the truth; your word is truth.
- 18 In the same way that you gave me a mission in the world, I give them a mission in the world.
- 18 As you sent me into the world, I have sent them into the world.
- 19 I'm consecrating myself for their sakes So they'll be truth-consecrated in their mission.

19 For them I sanctify myself, that they too may be truly sanctified.

20 I'm praying not only for them But also for those who will believe in me
Because of them and their witness about me.

20 My prayer is not for them alone. I pray also for those who will believe
in me through their message,

21 The goal is for all of them to become one heart and mind-- Just as you,
Father, are in me and I in you, So they might be one heart and mind with
us. Then the world might believe that you, in fact, sent me.

21 that all of them may be one, Father, just as you are in me and I am in
you. May they also be in us so that the world may believe that you have
sent me.

22 The same glory you gave me, I gave them, So they'll be as unified and
together as we are--

22 I have given them the glory that you gave me, that they may be one as
we are one:

23 I in them and you in me. Then they'll be mature in this oneness, And
give the godless world evidence That you've sent me and loved them In
the same way you've loved me.

23 I in them and you in me. May they be brought to complete unity to let
the world know that you sent me and have loved them even as you have
loved me.

24 Father, I want those you gave me To be with me, right where I am, So
they can see my glory, the splendor you gave me, Having loved me Long
before there ever was a world.

24 Father, I want those you have given me to be with me where I am, and
to see my glory, the glory you have given me because you loved me
before the creation of the world.

25 Righteous Father, the world has never known you, But I have known
you, and these disciples know That you sent me on this mission.

25 Righteous Father, though the world does not know you, I know you, and
they know that you have sent me.

26 I have made your very being known to them-- Who you are and what
you do-- And continue to make it known, So that your love for me Might
be in them Exactly as I am in them.

26 I have made you known to them, and will continue to make you known
in order that the love you have for me may be in them and that I myself

may be in them."

John 18

MSG

NIV

- 1 Jesus, having prayed this prayer, left with his disciples and crossed over the brook Kidron at a place where there was a garden. He and his disciples entered it.
- 1 When he had finished praying, Jesus left with his disciples and crossed the Kidron Valley. On the other side there was an olive grove, and he and his disciples went into it.
- 2 Judas, his betrayer, knew the place because Jesus and his disciples went there often.
- 2 Now Judas, who betrayed him, knew the place, because Jesus had often met there with his disciples.
- 3 So Judas led the way to the garden, and the Roman soldiers and police sent by the high priests and Pharisees followed. They arrived there with lanterns and torches and swords.
- 3 So Judas came to the grove, guiding a detachment of soldiers and some officials from the chief priests and Pharisees. They were carrying torches, lanterns and weapons.
- 4 Jesus, knowing by now everything that was coming down on him, went out and met them. He said, "Who are you after?" They answered, "Jesus the Nazarene."
- 4 Jesus, knowing all that was going to happen to him, went out and asked them, "Who is it you want?"
- 5 He said, "That's me." The soldiers recoiled, totally taken aback. Judas, his betrayer, stood out like a sore thumb.
- 5 Jesus of Nazareth, they replied. "I am he," Jesus said. (And Judas the traitor was standing there with them.)
- 6 (SEE 18:5)
- 6 When Jesus said, "I am he," they drew back and fell to the ground.
- 7 Jesus asked again, "Who are you after?" They answered, "Jesus the Nazarene."

- 7 Again he asked them, "Who is it you want?" And they said, "Jesus of Nazareth."
- 8 "I told you," said Jesus, "that's me. I'm the one. So if it's me you're after, let these others go."
- 8 I told you that I am he, Jesus answered. "If you are looking for me, then let these men go."
- 9 (This validated the words in his prayer, "I didn't lose one of those you gave.")
- 9 This happened so that the words he had spoken would be fulfilled: "I have not lost one of those you gave me."
- 10 Just then Simon Peter, who was carrying a sword, pulled it from its sheath and struck the Chief Priest's servant, cutting off his right ear. Malchus was the servant's name.
- 10 Then Simon Peter, who had a sword, drew it and struck the high priest's servant, cutting off his right ear. (The servant's name was Malchus.)
- 11 Jesus ordered Peter, "Put back your sword. Do you think for a minute I'm not going to drink this cup the Father gave me?"
- 11 Jesus commanded Peter, "Put your sword away! Shall I not drink the cup the Father has given me?"
- 12 Then the Roman soldiers under their commander, joined by the Jewish police, seized Jesus and tied him up.
- 12 Then the detachment of soldiers with its commander and the Jewish officials arrested Jesus. They bound him
- 13 They took him first to Annas, father-in-law of Caiaphas. Caiaphas was the Chief Priest that year.
- 13 and brought him first to Annas, who was the father-in-law of Caiaphas, the high priest that year.
- 14 It was Caiaphas who had advised the Jews that it was to their advantage that one man die for the people.
- 14 Caiaphas was the one who had advised the Jews that it would be good if one man died for the people.
- 15 Simon Peter and another disciple followed Jesus. That other disciple was known to the Chief Priest, and so he went in with Jesus to the Chief Priest's courtyard.
- 15 Simon Peter and another disciple were following Jesus. Because this disciple was known to the high priest, he went with Jesus into the high

- priest's courtyard,
- 16 Peter had to stay outside. Then the other disciple went out, spoke to the doorkeeper, and got Peter in.
- 16 but Peter had to wait outside at the door. The other disciple, who was known to the high priest, came back, spoke to the girl on duty there and brought Peter in.
- 17 The young woman who was the doorkeeper said to Peter, "Aren't you one of this man's disciples?" He said, "No, I'm not."
- 17 You are not one of his disciples, are you? the girl at the door asked Peter. He replied, "I am not."
- 18 The servants and police had made a fire because of the cold and were huddled there warming themselves. Peter stood with them, trying to get warm.
- 18 It was cold, and the servants and officials stood around a fire they had made to keep warm. Peter also was standing with them, warming himself.
- 19 Annas interrogated Jesus regarding his disciples and his teaching.
- 19 Meanwhile, the high priest questioned Jesus about his disciples and his teaching.
- 20 Jesus answered, "I've spoken openly in public. I've taught regularly in meeting places and the Temple, where the Jews all come together. Everything has been out in the open. I've said nothing in secret.
- 20 I have spoken openly to the world, Jesus replied. "I always taught in synagogues or at the temple, where all the Jews come together. I said nothing in secret.
- 21 So why are you treating me like a conspirator? Question those who have been listening to me. They know well what I have said. My teachings have all been aboveboard."
- 21 Why question me? Ask those who heard me. Surely they know what I said."
- 22 When he said this, one of the policemen standing there slapped Jesus across the face, saying, "How dare you speak to the Chief Priest like that!"
- 22 When Jesus said this, one of the officials nearby struck him in the face. "Is this the way you answer the high priest?" he demanded.

- 23 Jesus replied, "If I've said something wrong, prove it. But if I've spoken the plain truth, why this slapping around?"
- 23 If I said something wrong, Jesus replied, "testify as to what is wrong. But if I spoke the truth, why did you strike me?"
- 24 Then Annas sent him, still tied up, to the Chief Priest Caiaphas.
- 24 Then Annas sent him, still bound, to Caiaphas the high priest.
- 25 Meanwhile, Simon Peter was back at the fire, still trying to get warm. The others there said to him, "Aren't you one of his disciples?" He denied it, "Not me."
- 25 As Simon Peter stood warming himself, he was asked, "You are not one of his disciples, are you?" He denied it, saying, "I am not."
- 26 One of the Chief Priest's servants, a relative of the man whose ear Peter had cut off, said, "Didn't I see you in the garden with him?"
- 26 One of the high priest's servants, a relative of the man whose ear Peter had cut off, challenged him, "Didn't I see you with him in the olive grove?"
- 27 Again, Peter denied it. Just then a rooster crowed.
- 27 Again Peter denied it, and at that moment a rooster began to crow.
- 28 They led Jesus then from Caiaphas to the Roman governor's palace. It was early morning. They themselves didn't enter the palace because they didn't want to be disqualified from eating the Passover.
- 28 Then the Jews led Jesus from Caiaphas to the palace of the Roman governor. By now it was early morning, and to avoid ceremonial uncleanness the Jews did not enter the palace; they wanted to be able to eat the Passover.
- 29 So Pilate came out to them and spoke. "What charge do you bring against this man?"
- 29 So Pilate came out to them and asked, "What charges are you bringing against this man?"
- 30 They said, "If he hadn't been doing something evil, do you think we'd be here bothering you?"
- 30 If he were not a criminal, they replied, "we would not have handed him over to you."
- 31 Pilate said, "You take him. Judge him by your law." The Jews said, "We're not allowed to kill anyone."

31 Pilate said, "Take him yourselves and judge him by your own law." "But we have no right to execute anyone," the Jews objected.

32 (This would confirm Jesus' word indicating the way he would die.)

32 This happened so that the words Jesus had spoken indicating the kind of death he was going to die would be fulfilled.

33 Pilate went back into the palace and called for Jesus. He said, "Are you the 'King of the Jews'?"

33 Pilate then went back inside the palace, summoned Jesus and asked him, "Are you the king of the Jews?"

34 Jesus answered, "Are you saying this on your own, or did others tell you this about me?"

34 Is that your own idea, Jesus asked, "or did others talk to you about me?"

35 Pilate said, "Do I look like a Jew? Your people and your high priests turned you over to me. What did you do?"

35 Am I a Jew? Pilate replied. "It was your people and your chief priests who handed you over to me. What is it you have done?"

36 "My kingdom," said Jesus, "doesn't consist of what you see around you. If it did, my followers would fight so that I wouldn't be handed over to the Jews. But I'm not that kind of king, not the world's kind of king."

36 Jesus said, "My kingdom is not of this world. If it were, my servants would fight to prevent my arrest by the Jews. But now my kingdom is from another place."

37 Then Pilate said, "So, are you a king or not?" Jesus answered, "You tell me. Because I am King, I was born and entered the world so that I could witness to the truth. Everyone who cares for truth, who has any feeling for the truth, recognizes my voice."

37 You are a king, then! said Pilate. Jesus answered, "You are right in saying I am a king. In fact, for this reason I was born, and for this I came into the world, to testify to the truth. Everyone on the side of truth listens to me."

38 Pilate said, "What is truth?" Then he went back out to the Jews and told them, "I find nothing wrong in this man."

38 What is truth? Pilate asked. With this he went out again to the Jews and said, "I find no basis for a charge against him."

39 It's your custom that I pardon one prisoner at Passover. Do you want me to pardon the 'King of the Jews'?"

- 39 But it is your custom for me to release to you one prisoner at the time of the Passover. Do you want me to release 'the king of the Jews'?"
- 40 They shouted back, "Not this one, but Barabbas!" Barabbas was a Jewish freedom fighter.
- 40 They shouted back, "No, not him! Give us Barabbas!" Now Barabbas had taken part in a rebellion.

John 19

MSG

NIV

- 1 So Pilate took Jesus and had him whipped.
- 1 Then Pilate took Jesus and had him flogged.
- 2 The soldiers, having braided a crown from thorns, set it on his head, threw a purple robe over him,
- 2 The soldiers twisted together a crown of thorns and put it on his head. They clothed him in a purple robe
- 3 and approached him with, "Hail, King of the Jews!" Then they greeted him with slaps in the face.
- 3 and went up to him again and again, saying, "Hail, king of the Jews!" And they struck him in the face.
- 4 Pilate went back out again and said to them, "I present him to you, but I want you to know that I do not find him guilty of any crime."
- 4 Once more Pilate came out and said to the Jews, "Look, I am bringing him out to you to let you know that I find no basis for a charge against him."
- 5 Just then Jesus came out wearing the thorn crown and purple robe. Pilate announced, "Here he is: the Man."
- 5 When Jesus came out wearing the crown of thorns and the purple robe, Pilate said to them, "Here is the man!"
- 6 When the high priests and police saw him, they shouted in a frenzy, "Crucify! Crucify!" Pilate told them, "You take him. You crucify him. I find nothing wrong with him."
- 6 As soon as the chief priests and their officials saw him, they shouted, "Crucify! Crucify!" But Pilate answered, "You take him and crucify him. As for me, I find no basis for a charge against him."

- 7 The Jews answered, "We have a law, and by that law he must die because he claimed to be the Son of God."
- 7 The Jews insisted, "We have a law, and according to that law he must die, because he claimed to be the Son of God."
- 8 When Pilate heard this, he became even more scared.
- 8 When Pilate heard this, he was even more afraid,
- 9 He went back into the palace and said to Jesus, "Where did you come from?" Jesus gave no answer.
- 9 and he went back inside the palace. "Where do you come from?" he asked Jesus, but Jesus gave him no answer.
- 10 Pilate said, "You won't talk? Don't you know that I have the authority to pardon you, and the authority to--crucify you?"
- 10 Do you refuse to speak to me? Pilate said. "Don't you realize I have power either to free you or to crucify you?"
- 11 Jesus said, "You haven't a shred of authority over me except what has been given you from heaven. That's why the one who betrayed me to you has committed a far greater fault."
- 11 Jesus answered, "You would have no power over me if it were not given to you from above. Therefore the one who handed me over to you is guilty of a greater sin."
- 12 At this, Pilate tried his best to pardon him, but the Jews shouted him down: "If you pardon this man, you're no friend of Caesar's. Anyone setting himself up as 'king' defies Caesar."
- 12 From then on, Pilate tried to set Jesus free, but the Jews kept shouting, "If you let this man go, you are no friend of Caesar. Anyone who claims to be a king opposes Caesar."
- 13 When Pilate heard those words, he led Jesus outside. He sat down at the judgment seat in the area designated Stone Court (in Hebrew, Gabbatha).
- 13 When Pilate heard this, he brought Jesus out and sat down on the judge's seat at a place known as the Stone Pavement (which in Aramaic is Gabbatha).
- 14 It was the preparation day for Passover. The hour was noon. Pilate said to the Jews, "Here is your king."
- 14 It was the day of Preparation of Passover Week, about the sixth hour. "Here is your king," Pilate said to the Jews.

- 15 They shouted back, "Kill him! Kill him! Crucify him!" Pilate said, "I am to crucify your king?" The high priests answered, "We have no king except Caesar."
- 15 But they shouted, "Take him away! Take him away! Crucify him!" "Shall I crucify your king?" Pilate asked. "We have no king but Caesar," the chief priests answered.
- 16 Pilate caved in to their demand. He turned him over to be crucified. They took Jesus away.
- 16 Finally Pilate handed him over to them to be crucified. So the soldiers took charge of Jesus.
- 17 Carrying his cross, Jesus went out to the place called Skull Hill (the name in Hebrew is Golgotha),
- 17 Carrying his own cross, he went out to the place of the Skull (which in Aramaic is called Golgotha).
- 18 where they crucified him, and with him two others, one on each side, Jesus in the middle.
- 18 Here they crucified him, and with him two others--one on each side and Jesus in the middle.
- 19 Pilate wrote a sign and had it placed on the cross. It read: JESUS THE NAZARENE THE KING OF THE JEWS.
- 19 Pilate had a notice prepared and fastened to the cross. It read: JESUS OF NAZARETH, THE KING OF THE JEWS.
- 20 Many of the Jews read the sign because the place where Jesus was crucified was right next to the city. It was written in Hebrew, Latin, and Greek.
- 20 Many of the Jews read this sign, for the place where Jesus was crucified was near the city, and the sign was written in Aramaic, Latin and Greek.
- 21 The Jewish high priests objected. "Don't write," they said to Pilate, "'The King of the Jews.' Make it, 'This man said, 'I am the King of the Jews.'""
- 21 The chief priests of the Jews protested to Pilate, "Do not write 'The King of the Jews,' but that this man claimed to be king of the Jews."
- 22 Pilate said, "What I've written, I've written."
- 22 Pilate answered, "What I have written, I have written."
- 23 When they crucified him, the Roman soldiers took his clothes and divided them up four ways, to each soldier a fourth. But his robe was

- seamless, a single piece of weaving,
- 23 When the soldiers crucified Jesus, they took his clothes, dividing them into four shares, one for each of them, with the undergarment remaining. This garment was seamless, woven in one piece from top to bottom.
- 24 so they said to each other, "Let's not tear it up. Let's throw dice to see who gets it." This confirmed the Scripture that said, "They divided up my clothes among them and threw dice for my coat." (The soldiers validated the Scriptures!) While the soldiers were looking after themselves,
- 24 Let's not tear it, they said to one another. "Let's decide by lot who will get it." This happened that the scripture might be fulfilled which said, "They divided my garments among them and cast lots for my clothing." So this is what the soldiers did.
- 25 Jesus' mother, his aunt, Mary the wife of Clopas, and Mary Magdalene stood at the foot of the cross.
- 25 Near the cross of Jesus stood his mother, his mother's sister, Mary the wife of Clopas, and Mary Magdalene.
- 26 Jesus saw his mother and the disciple he loved standing near her. He said to his mother, "Woman, here is your son."
- 26 When Jesus saw his mother there, and the disciple whom he loved standing nearby, he said to his mother, "Dear woman, here is your son,"
- 27 Then to the disciple, "Here is your mother." From that moment the disciple accepted her as his own mother.
- 27 and to the disciple, "Here is your mother." From that time on, this disciple took her into his home.
- 28 Jesus, seeing that everything had been completed so that the Scripture record might also be complete, then said, "I'm thirsty."
- 28 Later, knowing that all was now completed, and so that the Scripture would be fulfilled, Jesus said, "I am thirsty."
- 29 A jug of sour wine was standing by. Someone put a sponge soaked with the wine on a javelin and lifted it to his mouth.
- 29 A jar of wine vinegar was there, so they soaked a sponge in it, put the sponge on a stalk of the hyssop plant, and lifted it to Jesus' lips.
- 30 After he took the wine, Jesus said, "It's done . . . complete." Bowing his head, he offered up his spirit.

- 30 When he had received the drink, Jesus said, "It is finished." With that, he bowed his head and gave up his spirit.
- 31 Then the Jews, since it was the day of Sabbath preparation, and so the bodies wouldn't stay on the crosses over the Sabbath (it was a high holy day that year), petitioned Pilate that their legs be broken to speed death, and the bodies taken down.
- 31 Now it was the day of Preparation, and the next day was to be a special Sabbath. Because the Jews did not want the bodies left on the crosses during the Sabbath, they asked Pilate to have the legs broken and the bodies taken down.
- 32 So the soldiers came and broke the legs of the first man crucified with Jesus, and then the other.
- 32 The soldiers therefore came and broke the legs of the first man who had been crucified with Jesus, and then those of the other.
- 33 When they got to Jesus, they saw that he was already dead, so they didn't break his legs.
- 33 But when they came to Jesus and found that he was already dead, they did not break his legs.
- 34 One of the soldiers stabbed him in the side with his spear. Blood and water gushed out.
- 34 Instead, one of the soldiers pierced Jesus' side with a spear, bringing a sudden flow of blood and water.
- 35 The eyewitness to these things has presented an accurate report. He saw it himself and is telling the truth so that you, also, will believe.
- 35 The man who saw it has given testimony, and his testimony is true. He knows that he tells the truth, and he testifies so that you also may believe.
- 36 These things that happened confirmed the Scripture, "Not a bone in his body was broken,"
- 36 These things happened so that the scripture would be fulfilled: "Not one of his bones will be broken,"
- 37 and the other Scripture that reads, "They will stare at the one they pierced."
- 37 and, as another scripture says, "They will look on the one they have pierced."

- 38 After all this, Joseph of Arimathea (he was a disciple of Jesus, but secretly, because he was intimidated by the Jews) petitioned Pilate to take the body of Jesus. Pilate gave permission. So Joseph came and took the body.
- 38 Later, Joseph of Arimathea asked Pilate for the body of Jesus. Now Joseph was a disciple of Jesus, but secretly because he feared the Jews. With Pilate's permission, he came and took the body away.
- 39 Nicodemus, who had first come to Jesus at night, came now in broad daylight carrying a mixture of myrrh and aloes, about seventy-five pounds.
- 39 He was accompanied by Nicodemus, the man who earlier had visited Jesus at night. Nicodemus brought a mixture of myrrh and aloes, about seventy-five pounds.
- 40 They took Jesus' body and, following the Jewish burial custom, wrapped it in linen with the spices.
- 40 Taking Jesus' body, the two of them wrapped it, with the spices, in strips of linen. This was in accordance with Jewish burial customs.
- 41 There was a garden near the place he was crucified, and in the garden a new tomb in which no one had yet been placed.
- 41 At the place where Jesus was crucified, there was a garden, and in the garden a new tomb, in which no one had ever been laid.
- 42 So, because it was Sabbath preparation for the Jews and the tomb was convenient, they placed Jesus in it.
- 42 Because it was the Jewish day of Preparation and since the tomb was nearby, they laid Jesus there.

John 20

MSG

NIV

- 1 Early in the morning on the first day of the week, while it was still dark, Mary Magdalene came to the tomb and saw that the stone was moved away from the entrance.
- 1 Early on the first day of the week, while it was still dark, Mary Magdalene went to the tomb and saw that the stone had been removed from the entrance.

- 2 She ran at once to Simon Peter and the other disciple, the one Jesus loved, breathlessly panting, "They took the Master from the tomb. We don't know where they've put him."
- 2 So she came running to Simon Peter and the other disciple, the one Jesus loved, and said, "They have taken the Lord out of the tomb, and we don't know where they have put him!"
- 3 Peter and the other disciple left immediately for the tomb.
- 3 So Peter and the other disciple started for the tomb.
- 4 They ran, neck and neck. The other disciple got to the tomb first, outrunning Peter.
- 4 Both were running, but the other disciple outran Peter and reached the tomb first.
- 5 Stooping to look in, he saw the pieces of linen cloth lying there, but he didn't go in.
- 5 He bent over and looked in at the strips of linen lying there but did not go in.
- 6 Simon Peter arrived after him, entered the tomb, observed the linen cloths lying there,
- 6 Then Simon Peter, who was behind him, arrived and went into the tomb. He saw the strips of linen lying there,
- 7 and the kerchief used to cover his head not lying with the linen cloths but separate, neatly folded by itself.
- 7 as well as the burial cloth that had been around Jesus' head. The cloth was folded up by itself, separate from the linen.
- 8 Then the other disciple, the one who had gotten there first, went into the tomb, took one look at the evidence, and believed.
- 8 Finally the other disciple, who had reached the tomb first, also went inside. He saw and believed.
- 9 No one yet knew from the Scripture that he had to rise from the dead.
- 9 (They still did not understand from Scripture that Jesus had to rise from the dead.)
- 10 The disciples then went back home.
- 10 Then the disciples went back to their homes,
- 11 But Mary stood outside the tomb weeping. As she wept, she knelt to look into the tomb

- 11 but Mary stood outside the tomb crying. As she wept, she bent over to look into the tomb
- 12 and saw two angels sitting there, dressed in white, one at the head, the other at the foot of where Jesus' body had been laid.
- 12 and saw two angels in white, seated where Jesus' body had been, one at the head and the other at the foot.
- 13 They said to her, "Woman, why do you weep?" "They took my Master," she said, "and I don't know where they put him."
- 13 They asked her, "Woman, why are you crying?" "They have taken my Lord away," she said, "and I don't know where they have put him."
- 14 After she said this, she turned away and saw Jesus standing there. But she didn't recognize him.
- 14 At this, she turned around and saw Jesus standing there, but she did not realize that it was Jesus.
- 15 Jesus spoke to her, "Woman, why do you weep? Who are you looking for?" She, thinking that he was the gardener, said, "Mister, if you took him, tell me where you put him so I can care for him."
- 15 Woman, he said, "why are you crying? Who is it you are looking for?" Thinking he was the gardener, she said, "Sir, if you have carried him away, tell me where you have put him, and I will get him."
- 16 Jesus said, "Mary." Turning to face him, she said in Hebrew, "Rabboni!" meaning "Teacher!"
- 16 Jesus said to her, "Mary." She turned toward him and cried out in Aramaic, "Rabboni!" (which means Teacher).
- 17 Jesus said, "Don't cling to me, for I have not yet ascended to the Father. Go to my brothers and tell them, 'I ascend to my Father and your Father, my God and your God.'"
- 17 Jesus said, "Do not hold on to me, for I have not yet returned to the Father. Go instead to my brothers and tell them, 'I am returning to my Father and your Father, to my God and your God.' "
- 18 Mary Magdalene went, telling the news to the disciples: "I saw the Master!" And she told them everything he said to her.
- 18 Mary Magdalene went to the disciples with the news: "I have seen the Lord!" And she told them that he had said these things to her.
- 19 Later on that day, the disciples had gathered together, but, fearful of the Jews, had locked all the doors in the house. Jesus entered, stood among

- them, and said, "Peace to you."
- 19 On the evening of that first day of the week, when the disciples were together, with the doors locked for fear of the Jews, Jesus came and stood among them and said, "Peace be with you!"
- 20 Then he showed them his hands and side. The disciples, seeing the Master with their own eyes, were exuberant.
- 20 After he said this, he showed them his hands and side. The disciples were overjoyed when they saw the Lord.
- 21 Jesus repeated his greeting: "Peace to you. Just as the Father sent me, I send you."
- 21 Again Jesus said, "Peace be with you! As the Father has sent me, I am sending you."
- 22 Then he took a deep breath and breathed into them. "Receive the Holy Spirit," he said.
- 22 And with that he breathed on them and said, "Receive the Holy Spirit.
- 23 "If you forgive someone's sins, they're gone for good. If you don't forgive sins, what are you going to do with them?"
- 23 If you forgive anyone his sins, they are forgiven; if you do not forgive them, they are not forgiven."
- 24 But Thomas, sometimes called the Twin, one of the Twelve, was not with them when Jesus came.
- 24 Now Thomas (called Didymus), one of the Twelve, was not with the disciples when Jesus came.
- 25 The other disciples told him, "We saw the Master." But he said, "Unless I see the nail holes in his hands, put my finger in the nail holes, and stick my hand in his side, I won't believe it."
- 25 So the other disciples told him, "We have seen the Lord!" But he said to them, "Unless I see the nail marks in his hands and put my finger where the nails were, and put my hand into his side, I will not believe it."
- 26 Eight days later, his disciples were again in the room. This time Thomas was with them. Jesus came through the locked doors, stood among them, and said, "Peace to you."
- 26 A week later his disciples were in the house again, and Thomas was with them. Though the doors were locked, Jesus came and stood among them and said, "Peace be with you!"

- 27 Then he focused his attention on Thomas. "Take your finger and examine my hands. Take your hand and stick it in my side. Don't be unbelieving. Believe."
- 27 Then he said to Thomas, "Put your finger here; see my hands. Reach out your hand and put it into my side. Stop doubting and believe."
- 28 Thomas said, "My Master! My God!"
- 28 Thomas said to him, "My Lord and my God!"
- 29 Jesus said, "So, you believe because you've seen with your own eyes. Even better blessings are in store for those who believe without seeing."
- 29 Then Jesus told him, "Because you have seen me, you have believed; blessed are those who have not seen and yet have believed."
- 30 Jesus provided far more God-revealing signs than are written down in this book.
- 30 Jesus did many other miraculous signs in the presence of his disciples, which are not recorded in this book.
- 31 These are written down so you will believe that Jesus is the Messiah, the Son of God, and in the act of believing, have real and eternal life in the way he personally revealed it.
- 31 But these are written that you may believe that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God, and that by believing you may have life in his name.

John 21

MSG

NIV

- 1 After this, Jesus appeared again to the disciples, this time at the Tiberias Sea (the Sea of Galilee). This is how he did it:
- 1 Afterward Jesus appeared again to his disciples, by the Sea of Tiberias. It happened this way:
- 2 Simon Peter, Thomas (nicknamed "Twin"), Nathanael from Cana in Galilee, the brothers Zebedee, and two other disciples were together.
- 2 Simon Peter, Thomas (called Didymus), Nathanael from Cana in Galilee, the sons of Zebedee, and two other disciples were together.
- 3 Simon Peter announced, "I'm going fishing." The rest of them replied, "We're going with you." They went out and got in the boat. They caught nothing that night.

- 3 I'm going out to fish, Simon Peter told them, and they said, "We'll go with you." So they went out and got into the boat, but that night they caught nothing.
- 4 When the sun came up, Jesus was standing on the beach, but they didn't recognize him.
- 4 Early in the morning, Jesus stood on the shore, but the disciples did not realize that it was Jesus.
- 5 Jesus spoke to them: "Good morning! Did you catch anything for breakfast?" They answered, "No."
- 5 He called out to them, "Friends, haven't you any fish?" "No," they answered.
- 6 He said, "Throw the net off the right side of the boat and see what happens." They did what he said. All of a sudden there were so many fish in it, they weren't strong enough to pull it in.
- 6 He said, "Throw your net on the right side of the boat and you will find some." When they did, they were unable to haul the net in because of the large number of fish.
- 7 Then the disciple Jesus loved said to Peter, "It's the Master!" When Simon Peter realized that it was the Master, he threw on some clothes, for he was stripped for work, and dove into the sea.
- 7 Then the disciple whom Jesus loved said to Peter, "It is the Lord!" As soon as Simon Peter heard him say, "It is the Lord," he wrapped his outer garment around him (for he had taken it off) and jumped into the water.
- 8 The other disciples came in by boat for they weren't far from land, a hundred yards or so, pulling along the net full of fish.
- 8 The other disciples followed in the boat, towing the net full of fish, for they were not far from shore, about a hundred yards.
- 9 When they got out of the boat, they saw a fire laid, with fish and bread cooking on it.
- 9 When they landed, they saw a fire of burning coals there with fish on it, and some bread.
- 10 Jesus said, "Bring some of the fish you've just caught."
- 10 Jesus said to them, "Bring some of the fish you have just caught."
- 11 Simon Peter joined them and pulled the net to shore--153 big fish! And even with all those fish, the net didn't rip.

- 11 Simon Peter climbed aboard and dragged the net ashore. It was full of large fish, 153, but even with so many the net was not torn.
- 12 Jesus said, "Breakfast is ready." Not one of the disciples dared ask, "Who are you?" They knew it was the Master.
- 12 Jesus said to them, "Come and have breakfast." None of the disciples dared ask him, "Who are you?" They knew it was the Lord.
- 13 Jesus then took the bread and gave it to them. He did the same with the fish.
- 13 Jesus came, took the bread and gave it to them, and did the same with the fish.
- 14 This was now the third time Jesus had shown himself alive to the disciples since being raised from the dead.
- 14 This was now the third time Jesus appeared to his disciples after he was raised from the dead.
- 15 After breakfast, Jesus said to Simon Peter, "Simon, son of John, do you love me more than these?" "Yes, Master, you know I love you." Jesus said, "Feed my lambs."
- 15 When they had finished eating, Jesus said to Simon Peter, "Simon son of John, do you truly love me more than these?" "Yes, Lord," he said, "you know that I love you." Jesus said, "Feed my lambs."
- 16 He then asked a second time, "Simon, son of John, do you love me?" "Yes, Master, you know I love you." Jesus said, "Shepherd my sheep."
- 16 Again Jesus said, "Simon son of John, do you truly love me?" He answered, "Yes, Lord, you know that I love you." Jesus said, "Take care of my sheep."
- 17 Then he said it a third time: "Simon, son of John, do you love me?" Peter was upset that he asked for the third time, "Do you love me?" so he answered, "Master, you know everything there is to know. You've got to know that I love you." Jesus said, "Feed my sheep."
- 17 The third time he said to him, "Simon son of John, do you love me?" Peter was hurt because Jesus asked him the third time, "Do you love me?" He said, "Lord, you know all things; you know that I love you." Jesus said, "Feed my sheep."
- 18 I'm telling you the very truth now: When you were young you dressed yourself and went wherever you wished, but when you get old you'll

have to stretch out your hands while someone else dresses you and takes you where you don't want to go."

18 I tell you the truth, when you were younger you dressed yourself and went where you wanted; but when you are old you will stretch out your hands, and someone else will dress you and lead you where you do not want to go."

19 He said this to hint at the kind of death by which Peter would glorify God. And then he commanded, "Follow me."

19 Jesus said this to indicate the kind of death by which Peter would glorify God. Then he said to him, "Follow me!"

20 Turning his head, Peter noticed the disciple Jesus loved following right behind.

20 Peter turned and saw that the disciple whom Jesus loved was following them. (This was the one who had leaned back against Jesus at the supper and had said, "Lord, who is going to betray you?")

21 When Peter noticed him, he asked Jesus, "Master, what's going to happen to him?"

21 When Peter saw him, he asked, "Lord, what about him?"

22 Jesus said, "If I want him to live until I come again, what's that to you? You--follow me."

22 Jesus answered, "If I want him to remain alive until I return, what is that to you? You must follow me."

23 That is how the rumor got out among the brothers that this disciple wouldn't die. But that is not what Jesus said. He simply said, "If I want him to live until I come again, what's that to you?"

23 Because of this, the rumor spread among the brothers that this disciple would not die. But Jesus did not say that he would not die; he only said, "If I want him to remain alive until I return, what is that to you?"

24 This is the same disciple who was eyewitness to all these things and wrote them down. And we all know that his eyewitness account is reliable and accurate.

24 This is the disciple who testifies to these things and who wrote them down. We know that his testimony is true.

25 There are so many other things Jesus did. If they were all written down, each of them, one by one, I can't imagine a world big enough to hold such a library of books.

25 Jesus did many other things as well. If every one of them were written down, I suppose that even the whole world would not have room for the books that would be written.